The Moon Path

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 1, Episode 1

Late afternoon lay golden over Explorer Camp. Below the treehouse, a narrow path wound between the roots of an enormous oak. It was a good path for walking. It was a pleasant path for pulling a wagon.

It was becoming a rather alarming path for riding in one.

Nib came bouncing down the hill in a little wooden cart. His red scarf streamed behind him. A picnic basket rattled at his feet, and his goggles kept slipping over his nose.

“Lark! Good news! The Adventure Wagon is very fast!”

Lark swooped out of the oak. She was a teal songbird in a well-used explorer's vest, and she had been having a perfectly quiet afternoon until the wagon arrived.

“And the brakes?”

“That's the other news!”

The wagon struck a root. Nib's sandwich jumped out of the basket. He caught it with one paw while Lark grabbed the handle with both feet.

Ahead lay a very large puddle. Above it hung a very low branch.

“Scarf!”

Nib flung the end of his scarf around the branch. The wagon swung around the tree and stopped with a wooden squeak. Its flag carried on without it, then flopped over Nib's head.

“Excellent brakes.”

Something crinkled beneath a wheel. Lark brushed away the leaves and uncovered a battered explorer's case. Its corners were green with age, but its brass latch still shone.

Nib lifted the flag off one eye.

“Did we find treasure already?”

“We found something.”

Then Lark noticed you beside the path. She moved over, leaving room between herself and Nib.

“Want to open it with us?”

The latch was cool beneath your fingers. You lifted it. The lid sprang up, and a folded sheet of paper popped out, unfolded in the air, and landed squarely on Nib's face.

His nose poked through a hole in the middle.

“I can see where we're going!”

“That's a hole.”

“A very clear map.”

Lark gently unhooked the paper from his nose. She spread it across a stump, smoothing the creases with the edge of one wing.

“I'm Lark. This is Nib. I draw maps.”

“I build things.”

He glanced at the wagon.

“Almost finished things.”

“We could use another explorer.”

You leaned closer. Much of the map was missing. Ragged gaps interrupted its paths, and one whole edge had been torn away. But near the center stood a drawing of a magnificent tree. A tiny door nestled among its roots.

Lark's wing grew still.

“The Treasure Tree.”

“Does it grow treasure?”

“There's a secret room inside it. Nobody at camp has found the way in. My first camp map had this tree on it. I've wanted to find it ever since.”

“What do you think is inside?”

“I don't know yet. That's my favorite part.”

Nib measured the little door with his paws, then measured his tummy.

“I could fit through that. With a small amount of wriggling.”

First, however, they would have to find it. Lark followed the broken trails with a feather. Most ended at empty spaces. One surviving corner showed a lagoon, a patch of woods, and a river dock. Beside the dock was a drawing of a crescent-shaped lantern. A pale stone glimmered inside it.

“A moonstone. Look where its light falls.”

In the picture, a faint trail appeared beneath the lantern's glow. It continued toward the outline of a missing map piece.

“If we find that stone, its light might show us where to look next.”

“Then that's where we start. With the bit we've got.”

Lark looked at him, then folded away the blank planning sheet she had already taken from her satchel.

Together, you followed the surviving path: lagoon, woods, river.

Nib packed the picnic basket. Lark added a coil of rope. Nib added an umbrella and a wooden spoon. Nobody was quite sure about the spoon, but he seemed very certain.

With you beside them, the two explorers set off.

The lagoon shone between tall reeds. Dragonflies hovered over a narrow channel, and the woods waited on the other side. Just beneath the water, you could make out a row of flat stepping platforms.

Nib opened his umbrella and studied it thoughtfully.

“That is not a boat.”

“It could be a very small boat.”

A breeze turned it inside out. Nib folded it without another word.

Beside the channel stood an old trail machine. A moon was carved above its lever. Below the moon sat a small square key bearing a little letter: m.

“The old explorers put letter keys on their trail machines. Each key has a sound. This letter makes a little hum. Listen. Mmm.”

She closed her beak. Nib pressed his lips together and tried the hum too.

“Mmm.”

His goggles trembled down his nose.

“My nose is doing it too.”

“Lips together. Mmm. You can try it with us.”

The little hum hardly disturbed the dragonflies. It was a comfortable sound, tucked behind closed lips.

Lark pointed to the moon above the machine.

“Mmm… moon. Hear that sound at the beginning?”

She pressed the letter key. The machine hummed, and the first platform rose dripping from the water. But the key's retaining clip was loose. With a tiny clink, the key dropped out and landed beside a spare.

One was m. The other was s.

“I think your bridge dropped something.”

“We need the little letter for mmm.”

You examined the two keys. One had a straight stem and two little humps. That was m, the letter Lark had shown you. You fitted it into the empty slot.

The hum returned. One by one, the platforms lifted until a dry path stretched across the channel.

“A bridge you can hear!”

Before crossing, Lark bent the loose clip back into place. Nib gave the key a careful wiggle. It stayed put.

Then the wagon rolled safely over the water.

“I like this boat much better.”

The woods smelled of damp earth and green leaves. A storm had scattered branches across the paths and knocked down the direction signs. One trail marker remained: a moon above three carved pictures. Moss. A mushroom. The river dock.

Lark was studying the pictures when Nib spotted a muddy slope.

“Or… that way.”

It certainly looked shorter. It also swallowed the wagon's front wheel with a deep, satisfied plop.

Nib pulled. The wagon stayed where it was. His goggles slid down.

“The shortcut has become a long cut.”

Lark braced the wagon while Nib looped their rope around the axle. You helped them pull. The wheel came free so suddenly that Nib sat down in the mud.

When he stood, one foot wore an enormous brown boot.

“Let's use the trail clues.”

“You find the way. I'll watch the wheels.”

At the first fork, bare rocks covered one path. Soft green moss carpeted the other.

Lark said both names slowly enough to hear their beginnings.

“Rock. Moss. Mmm… moss. Which one starts with our little hum?”

Moss. You led the way onto the green path. The wagon rolled easily, and Nib bounced once on the springy ground.

“It's a carpet. The woods have a carpet.”

At the next fork, a yellow flower nodded beside one trail. A small mushroom stood beside the other.

“Mushroom. Flower. Listen for mmm at the beginning.”

Mushroom began with the sound you knew. Its path curved around the hill, passed beneath a fallen branch, and opened onto the river.

There, across the shining water, a little ferry waited at an island landing. On its roof hung a crescent lantern. Something pale glowed inside.

“There! That's our treasure!”

He took a triumphant step. His mud boot stayed behind.

Nib looked back at it.

“You can keep that.”

The dock was weathered silver by wind and water. Two bell ropes hung from a post. Beside them stood a copper control panel, streaked with dried mud.

Inside a dry wooden box, you found a book. The ferry on its cover looked exactly like the one across the river.

“A book about our boat.”

Lark settled beside you and opened it. The first picture showed an explorer holding a lantern over a map. Where the light touched the paper, a hidden path appeared.

“The moon ferry carries a special lantern. Its moonstone light can show paths hidden in explorer maps.”

“That's exactly what we need.”

On the next page, a drawing showed the dock's copper panel, then a bell. Lark read the instructions beneath it.

“To call the ferry home, first mend the mark on the dock. Then ring the bell beside the same mark.”

There was the little letter again. A straight stem. Two humps. You had met it at the lagoon.

Nib reached for a bell rope, then stopped.

“Hang on. What comes first? Fix the mark, or ring the bell?”

You looked from the book to the panel. The mark came first. Its copper groove was shaped like m, but the soft material inside had washed away. A break ran through the middle, leaving the bell post dark.

“The groove is still here. We can mend it.”

“I'll get the boat rope ready. And one spare.”

He made a sturdy loop, tested the knot, then made another loop large enough to fit over his own head. He considered it for a moment and wisely set it aside.

Lark brushed the mud from the copper groove. A small pot of soft repair paste hung beside it, with a broad-tipped tool tucked into the handle. Nib stirred the paste with his wooden spoon, looking pleased that he had packed it after all. Then he passed you the tool.

“Start at the top. Down. Back up and over, down. Up and over, down.”

You can follow that little m in the air with your finger, if you like. One downstroke. Then two rounded humps, each coming down to the bottom.

At the dock, you worked slowly along the wide groove. Lark steadied the paste pot. Nib kept the rope out of the water. The first stem filled. Then the first hump. Then the second.

A thread of light ran through the repaired letter, along the copper strip, and all the way to the bell post.

“Look! It goes all the way to the bell.”

Lark checked the book once more. First, mend the mark. Done. Next, ring the matching bell.

She gave the rope beneath m a gentle pull. A low, humming note traveled over the water. The ferry's little paddle began to turn, and the boat glided away from the island.

Nib caught its bow with his rope and pulled it alongside the dock.

“Hello, treasure.”

He stepped aboard and lifted the lantern from its hook. Its light shone through his whiskers.

Behind him, the boarding rope slipped off a short post.

The dock began moving away.

No. The dock was staying exactly where it was.

“Lark?”

“I see it.”

“The boat is doing a leaving.”

The ferry drifted into a lazy circle of current. A thick bed of reeds waited beyond it, and Nib was safely in the middle of the boat, but he would much rather have been in the middle of the dock.

He opened the umbrella and tried to paddle.

It turned inside out.

“Still not a boat.”

This time, however, he found a job for it. He folded the umbrella around the lantern and nestled the bundle between his feet.

Lark flew to a low branch. She could reach Nib, but a mouse and a lantern were far too heavy for one small songbird to carry.

“Keep the stone safe. We can call you back.”

“I've got the rope. I've got the lantern. Ready when you are.”

Lark returned to the dock. The copper repair still glowed. Both bell ropes hung within reach: one beneath s, and one beneath m.

You knew what the book had said. Ring the bell beside the same mark.

“Which little letter makes mmm?”

You found the straight stem and two humps. The little m. You took its rope and pulled.

The low note sounded again. A shiver passed through the ferry. Its paddle dipped into the river, turned, and brought the bow around toward home.

Nib sat up so quickly that his goggles tipped sideways.

“I'm doing a coming back!”

As the ferry drew near, he threw his spare loop. Lark caught it and slipped it over a broad dock post. Nib pulled from his end until the boat rested snugly against the wood.

“Rope on!”

“Boat stopped!”

He stepped ashore, checked the lantern, and let out a long breath.

“Treasure found. Mouse delivered.”

For a moment, nobody hurried. Water tapped softly beneath the dock. Nib unwound the umbrella from the lantern and gave you a small, sincere wave.

Lark settled beside you.

“A little letter did a big job.”

Evening was turning the river blue when the lantern opened. Inside rested a smooth, pale stone, small enough to fit in Nib's cupped paws.

“It's smaller than I thought.”

“Try its light on the map.”

You unfolded the torn paper and moved the moonstone above it. At first, nothing changed. Then a pale dot appeared. Another followed. A whole trail emerged beneath the glow, curving past the river toward a cluster of fruit trees.

An orchard.

Beside it shone the outline of another map piece.

“There! That's where we go next.”

Nib followed the new trail with a paw until it reached the torn edge.

“And after the orchard?”

“We'll find out when we get that piece.”

“One adventure at a time.”

You tilted the moonstone. Another faint drawing appeared in the margin: an explorer holding an extremely large sandwich.

Nib stared.

“It understands me.”

Lark opened a small treasure case. Inside was a soft-lined compartment, just the right size for the moonstone.

“Our first treasure belongs in your collection. We can take it out when we need its light.”

You settled the stone into its place. Nib laid his sandwich beside it.

Lark looked at the sandwich. Then she looked at Nib.

“That goes in the picnic basket.”

“Different kinds of treasure.”

By the time you reached camp, the treehouse windows glowed among the leaves. Nib parked the Adventure Wagon and wedged a large rock behind each wheel. Lark brought out the crew's journal.

On its first page, she had drawn the battered case, the torn map, and a small mouse with his nose poking through the middle.

“One adventure. One chapter.”

“Did you put the rescue in?”

“All of it.”

“Even the umbrella?”

“Especially the umbrella.”

You sat together beneath the treehouse lamp while Lark read. There was the lagoon, with its humming bridge. There were the mossy path and the little mushroom. There was the book that showed you what to do, and the broken mark you had mended together.

When she reached the picture of m, Lark paused.

“And it made this sound… mmm.”

The next picture showed Nib on the ferry, one paw holding the rope and the other resting on the bundled lantern.

“The umbrella helped very little.”

On the last page, a moonlit trail led into an orchard. Beyond it, Lark had left the paper blank.

There would be more journeys to put there. More pieces of the map to find. More chapters to read again.

For now, your first adventure was safe between the covers. Lark placed the journal on the camp library shelf.

“I'll bring the map next time.”

“I'll bring the wagon.”

He proudly showed you his new brake: an enormous cushion tied across the wagon's front.

Lark studied it.

“Those are your brakes?”

“Very comfortable brakes.”

Something small rustled down the path. An apple rolled out of the dusk, bumped against the wagon wheel, and stopped beside Nib's foot.

He picked it up. You all looked toward the distant orchard.

“Oh. The next adventure sent a snack.”

Above the treehouse, the first star appeared. On the library shelf, a new book waited. And inside the little treasure case, the moonstone shone softly, ready for whatever came next.

The Apple Catcher

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 1, Episode 2

The apple was still beside the wagon wheel. It had rolled into camp after your moonstone adventure, and Nib had been guarding it very carefully. This morning, it had one small bite missing.

“An investigation,” Nib explained solemnly. “I had to find out whether it was an apple.”

Lark spread your surviving map on the explorer case. In the moonstone’s amber light, the orchard line appeared again. She packed the map, stone, journal, rope, and umbrella. Nib added the apple.

As the wagon passed the camp oak, a wheel bumped its crooked root. “That tree has its foot out,” Nib complained mildly. Lark helped him steer around it. Then you followed the apple’s clue.

At the fork, Lark checked the little mark copied from your first adventure. You had met its closed-lip hum beside the lagoon. The new orchard clue could wait while you remembered the old one.

“Which little letter makes our hum?” Lark asked gently.

The orchard smelled of apples and damp leaves. A wooden chute sloped between two trees. Beneath it hung a catching cloth, but one corner had come loose. Fallen apples were heaped beside an old box on a low shelf.

Three more apples waited behind a wooden stop at the top of the chute. Nothing was moving now.

“I am an excellent apple basket,” Nib declared proudly. He spread his little arms. One apple filled them.

“You are a rather small one,” Lark observed gently. “Let’s mend the catcher before we release the next apples. We must keep that old box safe.”

A carved apple marked the brass catch. Beside it was a little letter with a round middle and a short stem: lowercase a. The other catch carried the m you knew.

“Listen at the beginning of apple,” Lark invited softly. “Apple. Ant. That open little sound is the sound for this a. Listen.”

Nib put his apple in the wagon, then stretched the cloth toward the post while Lark held the frame steady. The loose corner would reach the catch if you chose its new little letter.

“Find the little letter for the start of apple,” Lark encouraged warmly.

The corner caught, but its fastening loop still dangled. Without that loop, a heavy apple could pull the cloth free again. Two wooden picture marks showed where the loop might go.

Lark named them aloud: ant and moon. Nib kept both paws on the cloth. The waiting apples stayed behind their stop.

“Which picture starts with the same little sound as apple?” Lark asked clearly. “Then fasten the loop before you let an apple down.”

The loop held. You lifted the wooden stop, and an apple rolled down the chute into the cloth. It settled with a soft, comfortable thump. The old route box stayed safe on its shelf.

“Caught!” Nib exclaimed delightedly. He clapped so hard that his empty pockets flapped.

Lark and Nib gathered the apples from around the shelf. They put several in the picnic basket. Now the path to the box was clear, and the next apples had somewhere safe to land.

Lark opened the journal on a flat board. She placed the new a beside your familiar m. Two little letters could do something new together.

“Start with the open sound from apple,” Lark explained patiently. “Then close your lips into our hum. Keep them close together: am.”

“I am an apple catcher,” Nib announced proudly. “A catcher who also enjoys a snack.”

Lark pointed beneath the two letters. “Slide with me, then say am if you like,” Lark invited gently. “I’ll read the rest of our sentence.”

The old box had a little brass lift latch and an apple carved into its lid. It was dry and undented. Nib stood beside the shelf while Lark laid your surviving map on a flat board.

“We can open it safely now,” Lark murmured eagerly. “Lift the latch. Then see where the paper inside belongs.”

Inside lay a folded map section and an illustrated note. Lark read it aloud. Earlier explorers had kept pieces of their worn map in route boxes, so each part would stay safe until someone came along the path.

Your original section had four empty spaces beside it. The orchard piece fitted one. Two sections together now; three spaces still waiting.

Lark passed the moonstone above the joined paper. A hidden line appeared, leading through a windy hollow to a little roofed waystation on the ridge.

“Another small clue,” Lark remarked thoughtfully. “Enough for our next adventure.”

Nib drew the catcher in the journal. In his picture, every pocket held an apple. Lark wrote their new little word in the sentence, and you could join its two sounds again whenever you wished.

They tucked the first missing section into the case beside the original map. The moonstone and journal went with it. The empty route box closed neatly on its shelf.

“I am an apple catcher,” Nib repeated contentedly. He tossed his saved apple a little way up and caught it himself.

The catcher rested between the trees, fastened and ready. Your basket held apples for the road, and the ridge route was safe inside the case. The orchard’s little problem was solved.

A gust ran through the branches. The wagon’s small pennant fluttered. Nib looked from the pennant to the folded picnic cloth, then toward the windy hollow.

“I have an idea,” Nib whispered excitedly. Lark tucked the map away before the breeze could catch it. Together, you turned the wagon toward the ridge.

The Sail That Wouldn't Stay

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 1, Episode 3

The picnic cloth lay across the wagon. The apple catcher was behind you, and the first missing map section rested safely beside your original piece. The moonstone, rope, and journal were packed in the explorer case. Three spaces on the map were still empty.

A breeze slipped through the hollow. The wagon’s pennant fluttered, and Nib’s idea grew taller than his ears.

“A sail the size of the sky!” Nib announced grandly.

He tied the picnic cloth to a light wooden mast while Lark set chocks beside the wheels. The wagon stayed parked on the broad, dry path. The cloth swelled above it like a very ambitious pillow.

“A wagon the size of a mouse,” Lark replied cautiously. She held the rope and watched the cloth pull sideways.

Nib opened the journal to the apple page. He pointed to the little word you had joined before.

“I am a sailor,” Nib declared hopefully.

“I’ll read the other words,” Lark offered warmly. “You can read am. Slide its two sounds, or join them with me.”

The breeze grew stronger. Grass brushed against the wagon with a soft hiss. The wheels stayed snug beside their chocks, but the enormous sail tugged toward the side of the path.

Nib gripped his scarf. He looked at the rope, then at Lark.

“Perhaps the sky is a little large,” Nib admitted doubtfully.

“We can make a smaller plan,” Lark replied calmly. She eased the rope until the cloth stopped pulling. Nobody climbed aboard.

On the journal’s empty page, Lark drew a little curving letter. It bent one way, then the other: lowercase s.

“Listen to the grass,” Lark invited softly. “Let a gentle stream of air make our soft hiss. No hum, and no extra little vowel. Listen to the sound, then find its letter.”

Nib held the page flat on the explorer case. Lark drew the curving mark once more, slowly enough to follow.

“It looks as if it knows a bend in the path,” Nib observed thoughtfully.

“We’ll keep it beside today’s picture,” Lark suggested gently. “Curve round, then curve back. Write our new s.”

Beside the path, a low supply shelter held a folded mat and an empty cloth sack. A shallow patch of dry sand lay nearby. Lark named both objects aloud. Mat. Sack.

Nib considered sitting on the mat until the wind changed its mind. Then he looked at the empty sack, the sand, and the wagon’s low frame.

“Something small could help something tall,” Nib murmured hopefully.

“Let’s begin with the sound,” Lark invited warmly. “Mat. Sack. Which one starts with the soft hiss we just learned?”

Lark brought the sack to a flat spot beside the wagon. She folded its top outward so the opening stayed wide. A stitched line showed how much sand it needed. The sack would rest low against the frame, with a rope loop to hold it.

Nib scooped a little sand into it. The base spread into a soft, sturdy shape.

“A sensible sack,” Nib declared approvingly. “It knows where the ground is.”

“Fill it just to the stitched line,” Lark encouraged gently. “Then I’ll secure its loop. The wagon will keep waiting while we work.”

The filled sack settled low beside the explorer case. Lark fastened its loop to the wagon’s frame. Nib folded the enormous cloth down and tied it into a small sail. Every fold made the mast look less surprised.

The next breeze pressed against the little triangle. Lark tested the rope. The sack stayed low. The wheels stayed level. The small sail helped without pulling the parked wagon sideways.

Nib studied his first enormous plan, now folded into something useful.

“Still splendid,” Nib decided contentedly. “Just less sky.”

Lark showed the two versions in the journal: the great billowing cloth, and the small folded sail beside the low sand sack.

“Which sail helped our wagon stay steady?” Lark asked gently.

With the test finished, Lark removed the chocks. Nib took the handle while Lark guided the rope. Together, they brought the wagon up the broad path. The little sail helped when the breeze followed them. When it did not, your friends simply pulled.

At the ridge waystation, they parked beneath the shelter and set the chocks beside the wheels again. The case was safe. The first map piece was safe. Nothing new had been added to the map.

Lark drew the little sail and the sand sack on your next journal page. Your new s curled beside the picture. She read the connecting words aloud, and you could join am again whenever you wanted.

“Small sail. Sensible sack. Splendid sailing,” Nib murmured with satisfaction.

A soft tapping came from beneath the roof. Nib put one paw on the little table. Its far end rose a tiny way, then settled with another tap.

“That table has an idea, too,” Nib whispered suspiciously.

Lark smiled and set the journal safely on the flat floor. The wagon was steady, the windy hollow was behind you, and the tapping table could wait for your next adventure.

The Tipping Table

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 1, Episode 4

The wagon rested beneath the ridge shelter. Its small sail was folded, its wheels were chocked, and its sand sack sat low beside the explorer case. Inside the case lay your original map and the first missing section. Three spaces still waited to be filled.

Something tapped beneath the shelter roof. Nib put one paw on a little timber table. The far corner rose. When he lifted his paw, it dropped with another tap.

“An excellent table, apart from its standing-up,” Nib observed thoughtfully.

Through a small opening above the drawer, Lark could see a folded piece of explorer paper. She tried the handle. The drawer moved a tiny way, then caught.

Nib rolled an apple beneath the short leg. The apple rolled out again.

“A delicious table leg,” Nib murmured doubtfully. “Very poor at staying.”

Lark held the frame steady. On a repair shelf behind her lay several flat wooden offcuts. Beneath the picnic basket was your rolled mat. There were useful things here, if they could work out what to do first.

Lark opened the journal to yesterday's curving letter.

“Here is our soft hiss,” Lark invited gently. “Find s beside m. You can hear either sound again if you want.”

The table answered with a little tap. Lark drew a tall line on the empty page and crossed it near the top.

“This is lowercase t,” Lark explained clearly. “Put your tongue just behind your top teeth. Release a tiny tap of air: /t/. It stops quickly. We won't add an extra vowel. Listen, then find t.”

Nib tried the sound. His goggles slipped. He pushed them up without touching the table.

“A very small sound for a very talkative table,” Nib whispered suspiciously.

Lark set a beside t. She joined their sounds slowly into at. Then she put m at the beginning: m, a, t. Mat.

“Our mat could help,” Lark suggested hopefully. “Read at with me. Now join all three sounds in mat.”

Nib fetched the rolled mat and spread it on the shelter floor. Its corner was soft enough to fold, but firm enough to hold its shape.

Before they used it, Lark left room beside its label in the journal.

“Write t here,” Lark invited warmly. “Down from the top, then a short line across. You can follow my first mark or make your own beside it.”

Nib folded one edge of the mat into a small pad. Lark kept her wing against the tabletop. The gap beneath the short leg remained plainly visible.

“We need to fill that gap before pulling the drawer,” Lark explained calmly. “Put the folded edge beneath the short leg. I'll keep holding the table.”

The pad fitted. Nib pressed one corner of the table, then the other. Both stayed level. This time, when he pulled the drawer, it slid out with a gentle wooden sigh.

Inside lay the second missing section of your map.

“Not even a wobble,” Nib whispered suspiciously. He tapped the tabletop once more, just to make sure.

Lark laid the new paper beside the original and the orchard section. Under the moonstone's amber light, hidden ink drew a route down toward the river. A little island shelter waited at its end. Two spaces remained empty.

A tiny sketch of the Treasure Tree stood in the margin. Its upper branch divided into a fork.

“That branch looks familiar,” Lark murmured thoughtfully. She copied it into the journal before packing the fragile paper.

Nib sat on the unfolded part of the mat. Lark made another word by replacing the first letter of mat with s. Sat.

“Mat. Sat,” Lark read softly. “The same ending, with a different beginning. Try sat with me.”

On your new journal page, she drew the short leg, the folded pad, and the open drawer.

“What let the drawer slide?” Lark asked gently. “Was it pulling harder, or supporting the short leg? You can use our picture to explain.”

Lark held the table while Nib exchanged the temporary mat pad for a flat offcut from the repair shelf. The table stayed steady. Your mat could come with you.

Outside, the first raindrop spotted the path. Nib looked from the cloud to the old map's fraying edge.

“An excellent time,” Nib remarked cautiously, “for paper to have a roof.”

The table was fixed, the second section was safe, and your next route led toward the river.

A Pocket for the Map

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 1, Episode 5

Rain pattered softly on the riverbank. The ferry waited at its dock, tied by a stout rope. Your wagon stood on dry ground beside it. Inside the explorer case were the original map and two recovered sections. The newest line pointed toward the ferry's little island.

Lark opened the umbrella before opening the case. Its broad roof sheltered every scrap of paper.

“The map can wait here while we make a cover,” Lark explained calmly.

Nib was already drawing a plan. It had wheels, seven poles, a roof, and a little shelf for a snack.

“A portable palace for precious paper,” Nib proclaimed enthusiastically.

Lark looked at his drawing. Then she looked at the ferry.

“Could our palace fit in a pocket?” Lark asked hopefully.

Nib added a very large pocket to his picture. Then he rubbed it out.

“Perhaps we should begin with the paper,” Nib conceded thoughtfully.

They unrolled the picnic mat beneath the umbrella. Lark showed you its familiar label without reading it first.

“Try this word,” Lark invited gently. “Look right through to the last letter. You can join the sounds or ask me to help.”

The mat made a dry work surface. Nib laid spare weatherproof cloth across it, with two stiff backing boards from the packing kit. Small pegs and fastening clips rattled in a tin beside his paws.

Lark touched her lips together, then released one little puff of air.

“Listen: /p/,” Lark modeled clearly. “This is lowercase p. Lips together, then a small pop. No extra vowel. Paper and pocket begin with that sound. Find p beside t.”

Nib folded the cloth around one backing board. He tested the fold with a peg. It stayed closed without needing even one palace tower.

Lark laid out m, a, and t. She moved the last letter away and put p in its place.

“Mat ended with /t/,” Lark explained softly. “Now listen all the way through: /m/, /a/, /p/. Map. Join our new word with me.”

Nib made a second flat cover for the picnic mat. The covers had the same cloth, the same shape, and the same little fastenings. One would hold the map on its backing. The other would carry the mat.

“Very good pockets,” Nib declared proudly. “A little difficult to tell apart.”

Lark wrote a label on each. She left a practice space in the journal, too.

“Write p beside our pocket drawing,” Lark invited warmly. “A line down, then a little round part beside its top. You can trace my first one if you want.”

The new letter stood beside the picture. Nib lifted the two covers by their edges. Their labels faced you: map and mat.

“We need the cover for our paper,” Lark reminded you gently. “Read both words. Which one says map?”

Lark kept the paper sheltered while Nib slid it onto its backing in the chosen cover. The matching mat cover stayed beside it. No corner had to bend to fit.

One peg remained open at the last fold.

“I'll keep the paper flat,” Lark offered calmly. “Nib will hold the cover. Put this peg on the little clasp so our fold stays closed.”

The peg gripped the cloth. Nib pressed the fold once, lightly, as if tucking a blanket around a sleeping map.

Lark caught a raindrop on the umbrella's edge and let it fall onto the outside of the folio. The drop shone, rolled, and slipped away. When she checked inside, the paper was dry.

“Perfectly dry,” Nib murmured proudly. “And considerably smaller than a palace.”

Lark drew the two labeled folios in the journal.

“Why did we give the paper a cover?” Lark asked gently. “What might the rain have done if the old map were left out?”

The shower thinned to a few bright drops. You could see the island shelter beyond the reeds. Lark packed the map folio safely in the case. Nib put the mat in its own matching cover and returned the spare pegs and clips to the kit.

Then he slipped an apple into an ordinary pocket.

“Paper pocket. Picnic pocket,” Nib counted contentedly. “An orderly expedition.”

The ferry stayed tied beside the bank. Your map was protected, your supplies were packed, and the island could wait until everyone was ready to travel.

The Little Ink Box

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 1, Episode 6

Nib checked the ferry rope. He checked where it met the post. Then he gave the knot a small, thoughtful tug.

“Rope on. Mouse remaining,” Nib declared firmly.

Your map was dry inside its folio. The original section and two recovered pieces rested on their stiff backing. Lark carried the explorer case aboard while Nib settled the wagon on the deck. Nobody untied the rope until everyone was ready.

The ferry crossed quietly to the island. This time Nib stayed beside the rail. At the island landing, Lark looped the rope over a broad post before anyone stepped onto the dry bank.

Under a low shelter stood the little ink box shown on your map. Its lid was shut. Beside it were a sturdy bench and a brass tapping plate. A rod joined the bench to a small counterweight beneath the box.

Nib tried the handle. The lid stayed closed.

“Very determined ink,” Nib observed cautiously.

Lark brushed dust from an instruction strip. An old black drip spread across its edge. She leaned closer, then sighed.

“I think the ink has hidden the clue,” Lark admitted ruefully.

Nib peered beneath the drip. Two little words stood clear. An arrow ran between them.

“It left the sitting bit,” Nib observed with interest.

Lark took out the journal's practice strip. First she showed a familiar word from your map-pocket adventure.

“Try this one before we look at the new clue,” Lark invited gently. “Read tap. You can take its sounds slowly.”

She drew a short line and put a dot above it.

“Here is lowercase i,” Lark explained clearly. “It makes the short sound at the start of ink: /i/. A quick, relaxed sound. Listen to short a, then short i. Find i beside a.”

Nib kept his paws on the dry bench while Lark set s and t on either side of the new letter. She joined the sounds into sit. Then she changed i to a, making sat.

“The outside letters stay the same,” Lark explained softly. “Listen to the middle. Sit. Sat. Join sit with me, then try the other word.”

The bench looked increasingly inviting to Nib.

“A promising instruction,” Nib murmured hopefully.

Before they tested it, Lark opened the ink-box journal page.

“Write our little i here,” Lark invited warmly. “A short line down, then lift your finger and add its dot. Keep it beside our picture of the ink drip.”

On the real instruction strip, the first word stood above the bench. The second stood above the brass plate. The arrow showed their order.

“Read the two words from left to right,” Lark encouraged gently. “Which job comes first?”

Nib followed the first instruction. He sat on the bench. It lowered a small, safe distance on its pivot. Beneath the box, the counterweight rose into place. The brass plate moved free of its stop.

“Now read the next word,” Lark invited softly. “Use its instruction on the plate.”

With a small tap, the catch clicked. The lid lifted on its hinge and stayed braced above the box.

Inside lay the third missing map section, wrapped in dry cloth. Beside it was a little ink stamp for the journal.

“A splendid box,” Nib declared appreciatively. “It understands sitting down.”

Lark added the new section beside the others. The moonstone revealed a narrow path toward a meadow, with a nest drawn beside the bank. Only one space in the old map remained empty.

She pressed the stamp onto your ink-box page and drew the bench beneath it.

“What made the catch ready for our tap?” Lark asked gently. “Think about the empty bench and the bench after Nib sat down.”

Lark looked again at the old drip. It had covered part of the strip, but not the words they needed.

“Thank you for looking underneath,” Lark told Nib warmly. “I nearly stopped looking.”

Nib rose. The bench returned to its resting place. Lark packed the paper and stamp, and everyone boarded the ferry before the island rope came loose. Back at the ordinary dock, they tied it safely again.

Ahead waited the dry nesting bank. Behind you, the little box was closed, the island was quiet, and all four of your map sections were safe.

The Noisy Wagon

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 1, Episode 7

The ferry was tied behind you. Ahead, a dry bank curved toward the meadow on your newest map section. Nib pulled the wagon slowly along it. The protected map, mat, journal, and explorer case rode safely inside.

A little clatter followed every turn of the wheel.

Nib stopped. The clatter stopped.

He took one more step. Clatter.

On a fixed branch beyond the path rested a nest. A small bird slept inside, its beak tucked into its feathers.

Nib lifted one paw and began an extremely careful tiptoe. The wagon answered with an extremely ordinary rattle.

“I am being exceptionally quiet,” Nib whispered earnestly.

“Your wagon has another opinion,” Lark murmured gently.

She looked beneath the handle. A metal fitting was still attached to the frame, but its free edge knocked against the wood. Nib's feet were not the problem. The fitting needed a fastener.

Lark parked the wagon before the nest. There was room to work without touching the branch.

“We can mend the rattle here,” Lark explained softly. “Then the wagon can be quiet, too.”

First she opened the journal to your ink-box page. She showed sit, then sat.

“Listen to the middle of sit,” Lark invited gently. “Which of these two words has our short i? You can sound them out.”

Nib nudged his nose toward the tool kit. Two matching pockets were closed inside it. Their labels had three little letters each.

Lark drew a line down, another up, and a small arch back down beside it.

“This is lowercase n,” Lark explained clearly. “Put your tongue just behind your top teeth and let your voice hum through your nose: /n/. For m, your lips close. For n, your tongue goes up. Listen to both, then find n.”

“Nest. Nap. Nib,” Nib counted quietly. “A useful beginning.”

Lark placed i beside n. She slid their sounds together into in. With p at the beginning, the word grew into pin.

“In. Pin,” Lark modeled softly. “Join the two sounds, then all three. Our little fastener has a name we can read.”

Nib held the loose fitting against the frame. It stayed quiet beneath his paw, but he could not walk while holding it there.

Lark drew the wagon on a fresh journal page, leaving room for its new letter.

“Write n beside the wheel,” Lark invited warmly. “Down, back up, and over one little arch. You can follow my first mark.”

The two tool pockets faced you. One said pin. The other said tin. Neither was larger or brighter than its neighbor.

“Which pocket has the fastener we need?” Lark asked gently. “Read the beginning as well as the ending. You can ask for a sound if you need one.”

Inside the pin pocket were the small fastening clips packed with your folios. Lark brought one to the fitting. Nib kept the metal edge still.

“The opening is here,” Lark explained calmly. “Clip the fitting to the frame while Nib holds it.”

The clip closed with a little settling click. Nib lifted his paw. The fitting stayed against the wood.

Lark rolled the wagon a short way. Its wheel turned. The case rode smoothly. No clatter followed.

“Now we are both being quiet,” Nib breathed proudly.

The crew passed the nest on the dry path. The bird shifted its feathers, settled more comfortably, and stayed asleep. Nobody needed to touch the nest or creep beneath it.

At the meadow edge, Lark drew Nib tiptoeing beside a wagon with its fitting held tight.

“What stopped the rattle?” Lark asked gently. “Did we change Nib's feet, or did we fasten the loose metal?”

Nib inspected the portrait.

“A remarkably quiet drawing,” Nib whispered approvingly.

The pin stayed on the wagon. Spare clips returned to the kit. Your map still had one empty space, and the meadow was bright ahead.

A red ribbon fluttered from an old post between two animal carvings. This time Nib let the wagon roll to a quiet stop before he hurried to investigate.

The Red Ribbon

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 1, Episode 8

A red ribbon rustled on a meadow post. Beneath it hung a folded note. On one side stood a carved ram with magnificent curved horns. On the other stood a small wooden rat with a round nose.

The wagon was quiet now. Its new pin held the loose fitting against the frame. Your original map and three recovered sections rested safely in their folio. Only the final gap remained.

“The ram! Magnificent horns!” Nib exclaimed eagerly.

He took two steps toward it before Lark fluttered to the post.

“Magnificent,” Lark agreed warmly. “But what does the note say?”

Nib came back. The ribbon marked the place where a clue had been left. It did not point toward either animal. Both carvings had a little drawer beneath their feet.

Lark laid the unopened note on the explorer case. Before reading it, she showed you the label on your map folio.

“Try our familiar word first,” Lark invited gently. “Read it right through. What is the last sound in map?”

The folio stayed closed while Lark drew a short line in the journal with a little shoulder near its top.

“This is lowercase r,” Lark explained clearly. “Listen to the start of red and ribbon: /r/. Let your voice begin smoothly. Keep your tongue from tapping or rolling, and don't add an extra vowel. Find r beside m.”

The ribbon moved in a soft breeze. Nib steadied the case so the paper could not flutter away.

Lark placed r beside a and m. She joined all three sounds into ram.

“Ram,” Lark modeled warmly. “Read the whole word with me. The beginning is /r/. The ending is our closed-lip hum.”

Nib glanced fondly at the horns.

“A very well-dressed word,” Nib observed appreciatively.

Lark opened the note. Its first two letters matched ram. Its last letter did not.

Nib leaned forward, then stopped himself.

“I nearly chose before the end,” Nib admitted thoughtfully.

“We have time for the last sound,” Lark reminded him gently.

Before making the choice, she left space beside the ribbon drawing in your journal.

“Write r here,” Lark invited softly. “Down, back toward the top, and over its small shoulder. You can use my mark to help.”

The note lay open between the carvings. Its word was rat.

“This word tells us which carving to use,” Lark encouraged gently. “Try it yourself. You can speak the sounds, join them quietly, or ask for help. Then choose the animal it names.”

The final t changed the destination. At the rat's base, Lark lifted the ordinary little latch. Nib slid the drawer open. Inside lay the fourth and last missing section of your map.

“Small nose. Excellent drawer,” Nib declared delightedly.

Lark set the new section on its backing beside the others. There was the original, the orchard piece, the ridge piece, the island piece, and this final folded piece. Nothing more needed to be found.

In the moonstone's light, a faint route ran toward a drawing of a crooked root. A folded edge hid the rest.

The wind lifted a corner of the note. Lark caught it before the old paper could bend.

“Let's join everything under shelter,” Lark suggested carefully.

Nib looked at the fragile pieces and nodded.

“A grand discovery,” Nib murmured sensibly, “deserves somewhere flat.”

Lark untied the ribbon and tucked it into the journal. It would be useful when your loose adventure pages were ready to become a book.

On today's page she drew both animals, the little clue, and the opened rat drawer.

“Why did the rat lead us to the paper?” Lark asked gently. “Was it the most splendid carving, or did its name match every sound in our note?”

Nib stood beside the picture of the ram for a moment.

“Fine horns,” Nib told it sincerely. “We simply had different business.”

The last piece was safe. Eight journal pages rested together. Ahead was a sheltered clearing where all five sections could finally meet.

The Map That Came Home

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 1, Episode 9

For the first time, nothing was missing from the explorer case. The original map and all four recovered sections lay inside. Nib counted them twice, using the tip of one careful paw.

“A whole map,” Nib declared hopefully. “Some assembly required.”

The clearing was broad and dry. Nib braced the umbrella over the work spot. Lark fixed the little sail as a windbreak, with the sand sack holding its support low against the ground. They had brought their shelter with them in pieces, too.

Two matching folios rested in the wagon. Their labels faced outward.

“Read the word on the paper cover,” Lark invited gently. “Choose map rather than mat. Look all the way to the last letter.”

Lark spread the picnic mat herself. It made a soft, flat surface under the umbrella. Then she opened the chosen folio and laid its stiff backing on top.

The orchard section met the original. The ridge section continued its path. The island section joined neatly beside it. Each little road led into the next.

The meadow piece did not.

Lark turned it one way, then the other. Its edge was too short. A path ended in empty space.

“Perhaps there is one more piece,” Lark whispered anxiously.

Nib leaned close. Along one edge, the paper looked twice as thick.

“Perhaps there is one more fold,” Nib suggested carefully.

Lark stopped moving it. On the underside, a small flap had been tucked back along an old crease. No new cache was needed. The last connection was hiding against the paper they already had.

“Let's look at that doubled edge,” Lark invited gently. “Open the fold slowly, so we can see the whole drawing.”

The flap unfolded. Its little road continued the island path and curved around the crooked root. The edges fitted.

Nib let out a breath that made his scarf move.

“A very small fold,” Nib murmured appreciatively. “A very large difference.”

Lark brought the tool kit. Two pockets had familiar labels, pin and pan.

“We need the little clips,” Lark reminded you softly. “Read both pocket labels. Which one tells us where to find them? Listen to the middle if you need help.”

She used the spare clips to hold the edges against the stiff backing. No clip pressed on a fragile line. The joined paper stayed flat when Nib moved his paws away.

The moonstone rested in Lark's wing. Its amber light spread across the complete map. Hidden ink appeared along one continuous route: orchard, ridge, river, island, meadow.

Then the line curved back to a treehouse.

Lark stared.

“We came all this way to come home?” Lark asked, bewildered.

Nib turned the drawing until its crooked root pointed toward the oak in your first journal picture. Above the root, the branch divided in two.

“Perhaps we have not looked at all of home,” Nib murmured thoughtfully.

Lark opened the journal beside the map. The oak at camp was drawn from the front. The tree on the map was drawn from behind. The root and forked branch were the same shapes seen from different sides.

“Which tree in our journal has both these features?” Lark asked gently. “Use the root and the branch together. What does that tell us about where the route ends?”

The familiar tree suddenly seemed full of unfamiliar possibilities.

Lark drew the unfolded corner on your ninth page. Beside it she left space for a useful old word.

“Write map beside today's picture,” Lark invited warmly. “You can use our folio label to help with m, a, and p.”

Nib folded the sail and umbrella. The sand sack returned low in the wagon, the mat went into its own folio, and the complete map traveled flat on its backing. This time all its roads stayed together.

By evening, the wagon rested beneath the camp oak. Your treehouse stood above the familiar front steps. Beyond the crooked root, a narrow ground-level path curved around the trunk.

Lark looked along it, then closed the case carefully.

“Our map is finished,” Lark breathed wonderingly. “Tomorrow we can look at the other side.”

Nib settled beside the wheel.

“Home,” Nib murmured contentedly. “With a remarkably promising back.”

The Door in the Tree

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 1, Episode 10

The path around your own oak was narrower than the front path, but just as dry. Nib brought the explorer case. Lark carried the complete map on its backing. Above you, the treehouse roof peeped between the same old branches.

At the rear of the trunk, a crooked root reached over a curtain of vines. High above it, the great branch divided into a fork. Both matched the finished map.

Lark brushed the vines aside. A narrow seam ran through the bark beneath the root.

“It has been our tree all along,” Lark breathed in astonishment.

Nib looked up toward the comfortable front steps.

“We were living on the roof of the treasure,” Nib exclaimed.

Between the roots was a little brass flap. Three familiar letters shone on its front. Lark moved aside so you could see them.

“Try the instruction yourself,” Lark invited gently. “Read its whole word. If you want help, we'll join the sounds together.”

The word was tap. Nib followed your reading with a light tap on the flap. An ordinary catch clicked, and a shallow drawer slid forward. Another little word marked its front.

Lark set the matching folios on the dry ground. One held the picnic mat. The other held the joined paper.

“Which cover matches the drawer's word?” Lark asked softly. “Read map and mat right through to their different endings.”

Nib kept his paws beside the case while you considered the labels. He did not reach for the first one that looked familiar.

“I am waiting for the little sound at the end,” Nib explained proudly.

Lark took the completed map from its folio and slid its stiff backing into the shallow drawer. Above it was a small fitted lamp cup. She set the moonstone inside.

Amber light fell across the joined paper. The old hidden ink shone from the orchard line to the ridge, from the island to the meadow, and all the way back to the crooked root. Every piece belonged to the same path.

Behind the bark, a latch released.

Nib took the handle. The ground-level door swung inward on a broad hinge. Warm, dry air drifted out, carrying the smell of wood and old pages.

Inside stood shelves of illustrated explorer books. A great folding woodland atlas rested on a low table. On a little tray lay a golden acorn, small enough to fit your collection case.

Nib stared at the acorn. Then he looked very carefully around it.

“Is any of the treasure a picnic?” Nib asked with cautious optimism.

Lark laughed softly. She took the moonstone from its lamp cup; the latch stayed released. The stone returned to its traveling compartment. Nib set the acorn in the compartment beside it, where it rested snugly on the soft lining.

Beside the older books was one empty place. A plain cover lay below it.

“There is room for our story,” Lark murmured warmly.

You had nine completed journal pages. Lark added the tenth: the oak from behind, the opened door, and the small golden acorn. She left room beside the drawing for a word that had brought you here.

“Write tap on our last page,” Lark invited gently. “Use the brass flap if you want to check its letters. Three familiar sounds helped us open a very large secret.”

Nib brought the red ribbon from the meadow. Lark laid the ten pages in order and threaded the ribbon through their binding holes. The loose journal became one real book.

On the floor she spread three pictures: the torn map you had first found, the complete map, and the opened room.

“Which picture starts our adventure?” Lark asked softly. “Which belongs in the middle, and which shows how it ended? You can point, put them in order, or tell the story.”

Nib studied the picture of the torn map.

“It looked less promising on my nose,” Nib remembered thoughtfully.

Lark read a little of your new book aloud, leaving map and sat for you to join if you wished. Then she placed The Map Pieces beside the earlier explorers' books. It could be borrowed whenever you wanted to read it again.

The golden acorn stayed in your case. The completed map stayed complete. Your moonstone was ready to travel, and the library door remained open.

Nib settled his sandwich beside the case, carefully outside its treasure compartments.

“And a very small picnic,” Nib murmured contentedly.

Beyond the doorway, evening lay golden around the familiar oak. The atlas held paths for another day. Today, the lost map was whole, the Treasure Tree was found, and your first adventure had its ending.

The Bag at the Door

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 1

Morning slipped through the open door of the Treasure Tree. Yesterday’s damp leaves glittered outside. Inside, your finished adventure stood on the shelf: The Map Pieces. The whole map rested safely in its folio, beside the moonstone. Nothing was missing today.

“We found a library,” Lark declared delightedly. “Now we need readers!”

On the packing shelf lay three fresh invitations. Lark read their destinations aloud: Reed Hut, the Mill, and Fern Lodge. Nib dropped one into each of his new courier bag’s three pockets.

“Three deliveries,” Nib announced grandly. “One dependable mouse.”

He ducked under the strap. The bag settled with a soft thump. It was rather wider than the dependable mouse.

Lark brought two closed folios down from the shelf. They looked almost alike. One held the map; the other held your folded mat. Each had its own little label.

“Let’s take the map,” Lark suggested warmly. “Which label says map?”

With the map tucked safely into the bag, Nib marched toward the door. His feet made determined little pats across the boards. The bottom of the bag passed through. The middle passed through. Then the strap stopped dead.

“I have arrived,” Nib declared.

He glanced back at the packing shelf.

“At a very nearby destination,” Nib added doubtfully.

A loose loop had caught beneath the brass latch. The door was wide enough. The bag was wide enough. The strap had simply found the one place it could not pass.

Nib gave a small tug. The latch pressed a dent into the cloth.

“Don’t drag it,” Lark urged gently. “We’ll rub a hole in our delivery bag.”

You helped set the bag on the dry floor. Lark lifted the three invitations out, one by one, and laid them safely on the packing shelf. Nobody had received a delivery yet.

Nib drooped beside the doorway.

“A splendid bag,” Nib murmured sadly.

“A rather grabby latch,” Lark replied thoughtfully. “We need something soft between the brass and the strap.”

The shelf had two little cupboards. Their contents were hidden behind wooden doors. Lark drew a round shape, then a tall line beside it, on a small slate. A lowercase d.

“Listen to the beginning of dip,” Lark invited softly. “A quick little sound. Your tongue touches just behind your top teeth, then lets go.”

Nib tried it once. A tiny puff disturbed a speck of dust.

“A small sound for a difficult door,” Nib observed hopefully.

Lark set three letters in a row: p, a, d.

“Here are two sounds we know and our new one,” Lark explained patiently. “We can join them: pad. A soft pad can protect the strap. Slide with me, then say the whole word if you like.”

Nib leaned toward the cupboard nearest him. Then he paused. Both labels began with p. Both had a in the middle. That would not tell him which cupboard held the pad.

“I nearly picked the first one,” Nib admitted sheepishly.

“The last sound matters too,” Lark reminded him gently. “Find pad on the shelf.”

The cupboard opened. Inside lay a folded felt pad, just the right size. You carried it to the doorway. Its soft cloth wrapped around the sharp lower edge of the latch, leaving the handle clear.

Nib touched the strap. No new scrape. No deep dent.

“A padded problem,” Nib announced proudly.

“A protected strap,” Lark corrected him with a chuckle. “The loop is still caught underneath. We’ll need to do different jobs together.”

Lark fluttered up to lift the latch. Nib lowered the bag until its base rested on the floor. That made the strap slack. A clear opening appeared above the loose loop.

“I’ll hold this up,” Lark called steadily.

“I’ll keep the bag down,” Nib answered determinedly.

The loose strap rested within reach. You could guide it through the opening while your friends held their places. Nobody needed to tug.

“Bring the strap through the gap,” Lark urged encouragingly. “We’ll hold it for you.”

The loop slipped clear. Lark lowered the latch only after the cloth was free. Nib took one careful step backward. The bag came with him.

“It did!” Nib exclaimed delightedly. “It did go through!”

He examined the strap from end to end. The pad had kept it from tearing. Lark folded the pad around the strap’s worn spot and fastened its small cloth tie. It could travel with the bag now.

“We didn’t need a bigger door,” Lark remarked thoughtfully.

“Or a smaller mouse,” Nib added with relief. “Excellent news for the mouse.”

The three invitations still waited on the dry shelf. Lark read their destinations again and pointed to the matching pictures on the bag’s pockets: a reed-roofed hut, the Mill wheel, and Fern Lodge’s fern. You did not need to read those names yourself.

Nib held the pockets open, one at a time. Lark kept the bag steady. There was a separate place for every invitation.

“Three invitations,” Lark counted calmly. “Three pockets. Put each picture with its matching pocket, and we’ll check them together.”

One invitation in each pocket. Three invitations altogether. The map and route book lay in the main compartment, away from the damp patch on Nib’s scarf.

Lark opened a fresh journal. She drew the caught strap, the pad, and three friends doing three useful jobs. Nib added a very large doorway and a very small dent.

Beside the drawing, Lark fastened a little wooden tag from the packing shelf. She had written d on it.

“Our doorway tag,” Lark explained warmly. “For the first page of our delivery adventure.”

Nib held it up, then tucked it into your collection pocket. Your first courier page was ready to read again.

Outside, daylight dappled the dry path. Nib checked that the strap lay flat before lifting the bag. This time he passed through the door without a tug.

Lark opened the route book on a low, level stump. Its first picture showed a fish’s fin beside a fork in the path. She read the next direction aloud. That little word would be your next discovery.

“First stop: Reed Hut,” Lark announced brightly.

“First job: done,” Nib declared proudly.

He looked down at his dependable bag.

“Next job: delivery,” Nib declared eagerly.

With all three invitations safe, you set off together. Behind you, the library door rested open. Ahead, the woodland had readers to find.

The Fan at the Fork

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 2

The library door was behind you now. Nib’s courier bag swung gently against his scarf. Its strap wore the soft pad from your first delivery adventure. Inside, three invitations rested in three separate pockets. Reed Hut, the Mill, and Fern Lodge were still waiting for their letters.

“A dependable bag,” Nib declared proudly. He inspected the doorway tag once more, although the doorway was already far away.

“And a whole woodland ahead,” Lark replied brightly. She opened the route book on a flat stone. Its first direction named the fork beneath the ferns. You followed a dry path, with the bag between your friends.

Nib’s steps grew brisk. He was eager to make the first delivery. Lark paused beside a familiar little word on the first journal page.

“Before our new clue, here is a word we already know,” Lark invited gently. “Read am. Slide its two sounds if you want to.”

At the fork stood two wooden posts. One held a carved fish, with a splendid fin rising from its back. The other carried a small wooden fan. Four broad blades turned whenever the breeze slipped between the trees.

Nib watched the fan turn. He took a step toward its path.

“Very lively directions,” Nib remarked approvingly. “That one must be important.”

“It is moving,” Lark observed thoughtfully. “But movement doesn’t tell us which path the book names.”

She rested the open book on the stone. Both little labels began with the same new letter: f. Lark showed its tall curved line and its short line across.

“Listen to the start of fan,” Lark invited softly. “Touch your top teeth to your lower lip. Let the air flow gently. No hum, and no extra little vowel. Listen to our sound, then find its letter.”

Lark set f beside the a and n you knew. She joined the sounds into fan. Then she changed just the middle letter. The little i from pin made fin.

Nib looked from one label to the other. The beginnings matched. So did the endings. Only the small middle was different.

“I nearly followed the biggest moving thing,” Nib admitted sheepishly.

“We can read the whole word,” Lark reminded him warmly. “Our book names fin. Read both labels, and choose fin for our route.”

The little i settled the question. Lark pointed to the fish’s fin. Its path curved around the fern bank, away from the fan’s short viewing alcove. The crew stayed on dry ground. No one needed to cross the creek here.

Nib gave the fan a courteous bow before leaving.

“Excellent spinning,” Nib told it sincerely. “Different destination.”

At a low resting stone, Lark opened your courier journal. She drew the fish post and left space beneath it for the new letter.

“We can keep our f beside today’s clue,” Lark suggested gently. “Curve over, go down, then add the short line across. Write f on our page.”

Nib lowered the bag onto the dry path before adjusting its strap. One edge had folded over near the soft pad. He smoothed the fold instead of tugging at it.

Lark watched the strap settle flat. The bag still had room for every invitation. A tiny word on the journal’s checking strip ended with t. Nib studied it carefully.

“Our last sound matters, too,” Nib remembered proudly.

“It does,” Lark agreed warmly. “Read the whole little word. Find fit.”

The strap fitted comfortably again. Lark rested while Nib drew a very small story on the spare half of the page. His drawings showed two little mice called Sam and Pip, and a hand fan.

“A story about a fan,” Nib announced contentedly. “A fan that has no opinions about directions.”

Lark showed you the names before the reading. Capital S made the same sound as little s. Capital P made the same sound as little p. You already knew every sound in the words below.

“You can read this part yourself,” Lark invited gently. “Take each sentence in turn. Let your finger follow underneath, and tap a word if you want help.”

The little story had running, resting, and a helpful fan. Nib looked at his picture again. This time the picture could wait. The words told who had done each job.

“Who used the fan in our little story?” Lark asked gently. “You can look back at the sentences.”

Lark tucked the finished fork page into the route book. No new map section appeared. You had something more useful for today: the right path, a comfortable strap, and a clear record of the way you came.

The ferns thinned. Ahead, the creek flashed between pale stones. The path ended on a broad dry bank. A little clay pot stood on a low stump, and a reed-roofed hut waited across the water.

“Our first stop is getting nearer,” Lark murmured eagerly.

Nib counted the bag’s pockets with one careful paw. Three invitations. All safe. None delivered yet.

“First fork found,” Nib declared proudly. “First delivery still to come.”

A breeze stirred the reeds. Behind you, the wooden fan kept turning beside its own path. Ahead, the quiet little pot held the next clue.

On the Wrong Stump

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 3

Several stumps surrounded the creek landing. Nib climbed the tallest and raised one paw in triumph. From there he could see the reeds, the roof of Reed Hut, and very little of the low pot beside the path. All three invitations still rested in his courier bag.

“I am on the top,” Nib announced grandly. “We need the pot,” Lark replied patiently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **fin**

“Here is lowercase o,” Lark explained clearly. “Its short sound begins on and sits in the middle of pot. Listen: /o/. It is different from the short i in pit. Put p and t around each vowel, and hear how the word changes.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try on, pot, top, nod. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Our route key names pot,” Lark invited gently. “Read pot and pit, then choose the marker the note actually names.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

Dan sat on top. Sam did not.

“Who sat on top in that little passage?” Lark asked gently. “Find the name in the first sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark lifted the pot from its low stump. Beneath its base lay a folded crossing note. She read its longer words aloud: the creek handrail needed fastening before the crew crossed. Nib climbed down from his excellent viewing stump. The useful information had been lower than his nose all along. They replaced the pot and walked to the repair shelter.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write o beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the low pot and its hidden note. Across the creek, Reed Hut waited. The first invitation was still undelivered, but now the crew knew what needed doing before they reached it.

The Kit That Would Not Fit

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 4

The repair shelter had two cupboards. Nib chose an enormous empty cap box, imagining how splendid every tool would look inside it. When he lifted it, its corners hid the handrail note. The actual equipment cupboard was small enough to fit beside his bag.

“It is a capacious cap box,” Nib argued hopefully. “We need a kit,” Lark reminded him warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

on

“Lowercase c and lowercase k can both stand for /k/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Hear the short sound in cap, then kit. No extra vowel after it. We'll practice each letter separately before joining it to the sounds we know.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cat, cap, cot, kit, kin. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read cap and kit,” Lark encouraged gently. “Which cupboard names the equipment we need?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can sit on top. Pat can sit on top.**

“Can both friends sit on top, or only one?” Lark asked warmly. “Use both sentences.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Inside the kit cupboard were a short rope and a fastening hook. Lark flew the light rope across to the fixed far post. Nib fastened the near end and checked the line while the walking boards stayed firmly on their supports. They crossed with the compact kit and all three invitations. The giant empty box stayed where it belonged.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write c and k beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Reed Hut's porch was dry under their feet. Behind them the handrail stayed secured. Nib looked down at his small kit with new respect. It had brought exactly enough equipment, with no enormous corners to carry.

The Hat on the Handle

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 5

A hat hung over Reed Hut's door handle. Its brim covered the letter flap and most of the caretaker's hanging notice. The caretaker was working in the reeds, so the first delivery needed to follow the instructions left behind. Nib peered beneath the brim as if it might answer him.

“A hat has taken the postman’s job,” Nib whispered suspiciously. “It is keeping the handle warm,” Lark suggested kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cat**

“Lowercase h starts hat,” Lark modeled softly. “Let your breath flow gently: /h/. No hum. Join h, a, t into hat. Now change the middle vowel for hot. Hear the difference before you read the notice.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try hat, hot, ham, hip, hop. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read hat on the hanging notice,” Lark invited gently. “Which thing has been left over the flap?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam had ham. Pat had hot ham.**

“Whose ham was hot?” Lark asked gently. “Find the extra describing word.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the hat to its proper hook. The flap appeared below it. He lifted the whole courier bag, then remembered its separate pockets. Lark read the destination on the Reed Hut envelope and posted that invitation alone. The caretaker's note promised a reply in this same flap on the return journey. Two invitations remained packed.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write h beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal gained its first completed delivery. Lark marked the flap as the place to collect the reply. Then the crew followed the Mill path, leaving the hat on its hook and the invitation safely inside.

The Wet Pen

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 6

A shower reached the Mill route shelter before you did. The old visitor pen lay in a wet patch beside a blurred direction page. Nib tried one careful mark. It spread into an impressive puddle of ink. Later couriers would need a clearer direction than that.

“A very wet pen,” Nib reported gravely. “A dry one would be a splendid improvement,” Lark agreed.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **hat**

“Lowercase e makes the short middle sound in pen,” Lark explained clearly. “Listen to pen and pin. Keep p and n in place while the middle changes. The dry pen can write our message; the pin has a different job.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try pen, pet, hen, net, red. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read pen and pin on the kit pockets,” Lark invited gently. “Find what we need for a readable note.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

Sam met Pat. Pat fed Sam.

“Who fed Sam?” Lark asked gently. “Look at the name that starts the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib held a dry backing beneath a fresh page. Lark used the dry pen to draw the next turn beside a red route post. You could add red beneath the picture using familiar sounds and the new e. They hung the note beneath the roof, where the next shower would miss it. The two remaining invitations stayed dry in their pockets.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write red beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The wet pen stayed aside to dry. Your working pen returned to the kit. Beyond the shelter, a fallen log lay beside the Mill gate, and the gate would not swing. At least the route to it was clearly recorded now.

The Gate and the Log

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 7

Nib leaned against the fallen log. It did not move. He leaned more grandly. His goggles moved, but the log still did not. The Mill gate caught near its hinge. Lark crouched beside the bottom rail instead of pushing at the largest piece of wood.

“I was moving the large difficulty,” Nib explained breathlessly. “Let us try the small gap,” Lark urged gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **pen**

“Here g makes the sound at the beginning of gap,” Lark modeled clearly. “Use your voice for the brief /g/, without adding a vowel. Join g, a, p. Other words can give this letter another sound later; today we are using gap and get.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try gap, get, got, dig, tag. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read gap on the repair diagram,” Lark invited softly. “Which small opening does its arrow show beside the hinge?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Pat got mad. Sam did not get mad.**

“Which friend stayed calm in the little passage?” Lark asked gently. “Read the sentence with not.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Through the gap, Lark could see a loose branch wedged under the hinge. Nib threaded a short strap around that branch. Together they lifted only the loose piece. The heavy log remained stable on the ground. The gate swung free, and your two undelivered invitations entered the Mill yard without a single log being rolled away.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write gap beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the small branch beside the large log. The open gate was the result of moving the right thing. Ahead, round containers crowded the Mill delivery ledge. Nib kept the envelope in his bag while they looked for a flat place.

The Little Ledge

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 8

The Mill's delivery ledge was full of round tins. Nib balanced an invitation on top. It slid, glided down a curved lid, and landed neatly in his lap. He looked pleased to have caught it and less pleased to have become the delivery shelf.

“A letter in my lap,” Nib observed ruefully. “A ledge with a lip,” Lark replied with relief.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

gap

“Lowercase l begins lip,” Lark explained softly. “Touch your tongue just behind your top teeth and let your voice flow: /l/. Don't add an extra vowel. Join l, i, p. On this diagram, lip means the little raised edge that stops a letter sliding off.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try lip, leg, log, lap, let. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Find lip on the shelf sketch,” Lark invited gently. “Which edge could help our envelope stay flat?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam let Pat hop. Pat did hop.**

“Who did the hopping?” Lark asked gently. “Use the second sentence to check.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

One empty tray covered a lower flat space behind the retaining lip. Nib shifted that tray to an unused support and left the working tins alone. The envelope now had somewhere level to wait. Before posting it, Lark checked the collection diagram. A marked reply box beneath the bench still needed identifying.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write l beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the ledge with its useful lip. The Mill invitation remained retrievable beside the crew, and the Fern Lodge envelope stayed packed. A better shelf was ready; the right box was next.

The Box Beneath the Bench

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 9

Two boxes stood beneath the Mill bench. One was impressively large. The other had an ordinary-sized lid. Nib leaned toward the large box before reading either label. Lark set the invitation on the prepared ledge, where it could wait safely.

“Big box, big importance,” Nib announced confidently. “Small word, exact place,” Lark answered gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **lip**

“Lowercase b begins bag,” Lark modeled clearly. “A brief voiced /b/, without an extra vowel. Look at b beside d: b has its tall stem first, with the round part on the right. Join b, i, n to read bin.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try bag, bed, big, bin, cob. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read bin and kit on these boxes,” Lark invited gently. “Which word names our letter box?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Bob hid. Sam did not.**

“Who hid?” Lark asked softly. “Which sentence gives you that information?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The correct box was the letter bin, whatever its size. Nib posted the Mill invitation there. Lark read the collection card and drew the same bin on your return-route page. The Mill reply would be left here later. Reed Hut and the Mill now had their invitations. Only Fern Lodge's envelope remained in the courier bag.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write b beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the second delivery once. Nib closed the empty Mill pocket and lifted the bag. On the next path, a shallow puddle brushed its lower strap. The last invitation was dry, but the bag needed somewhere better to rest.

The Cup in the Mud

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 10

The lower strap dipped into muddy water while Nib checked the route book. Fern Lodge's envelope stayed dry inside its protective folio. Nib began to drag the bag away, then stopped when the wet strap pulled against its base. Lark pointed to a low dry stump nearby.

“My bag has dipped a toe in,” Nib remarked anxiously. “Let us lift the toe, not tip the bag,” Lark urged calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **bag**

“Lowercase u has the short sound in cup and mud,” Lark modeled clearly. “Listen to cup and cap. The outside sounds stay the same while the middle changes. We've now met five short vowel sounds; we can listen for the one each word actually needs.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cup, cut, mud, sun, tub. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read cup and cap in the kit,” Lark invited calmly. “Which one can scoop a little surface water away?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam dug. Pat sat in mud.**

“Who sat in mud?” Lark asked gently. “What did the other friend do?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib used the cup beside the strap while Lark brought the bag's handle onto its lifting hook. Together they lifted the bag clear and settled it on the stump without tipping its contents. Nib checked all three pockets. The only remaining invitation was dry. He clipped the muddy cup outside the protected message pocket before setting off again.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write u beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the bag lifted clear of the puddle. Beyond the muddy patch, sunlight warmed the Fern Lodge path. A sheltered rest would keep the crew comfortable before the final outward delivery.

The Shade That Wandered

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 11

Nib put the umbrella beside a resting board. Its shade fell beautifully over the grass. Unfortunately, the bag was on the board. When Nib moved the bag into the shade, he sat down in the sunny place it had left. Lark watched the patch of light with a thoughtful smile.

“The shade wandered,” Nib complained mildly. “The umbrella stayed where we put it,” Lark observed with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cup**

“Lowercase w begins wet,” Lark modeled clearly. “Round your lips, then move smoothly into the next sound: /w/. Join w, e, t. Compare wet with the sun label on our resting-place note. The words tell us something about each place.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try web, wet, win, wag. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read wet and sun,” Lark invited gently. “Which place is dry, and what does it still need for a comfortable rest?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam got wet. Pat did not get wet.**

“Which friend stayed dry?” Lark asked gently. “Find the word that changes what happened.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib set the bag on the dry board. Lark moved the umbrella's support so its shade covered that board, then anchored its base. Nobody disturbed the spider web beside the shelter. Now the dry resting place was shaded as well. The crew sat together, with Fern Lodge's invitation protected beside them.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write w beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

After the rest, Fern Lodge's porch was close enough to see. Lark packed the umbrella and checked the route note. A folded receiving sack hung beside the doorway, ready for the last invitation.

Pack the Right Sack

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 12

At Fern Lodge, Nib wrapped the final invitation in spare cloth. Then he added another piece, and another, until the destination mark vanished. The caretaker's receiving instructions were fixed beside a folded sack. Lark looked from the neat instruction to the enormous anonymous bundle.

“Packed beyond all recognition,” Nib reported proudly. “Recognition is part of the job,” Lark reminded him kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **web**

“Here c and k work together for one /k/ sound,” Lark explained clearly. “Read pack, then sack. Don't sound the pair twice. Capital P has the same beginning sound as little p. In Pack it, two words give us one useful instruction.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try pack, sack, back, sock. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Pack it,” Lark invited warmly. “Which protection keeps the envelope safe while leaving its destination visible?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

Sam can pack. Pat can pack.

“Can both friends pack?” Lark asked gently. “Check that each sentence tells us so.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib removed the extra wrapping. The protective folio fitted into the intended sack without hiding the destination. Lark posted the Fern Lodge invitation through the receiving flap. The caretaker's note promised a reply at the same sack hook. All three outward invitations had reached their destinations; the return circuit could begin.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write pack beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the sack hook as your third reply-collection place. Nib's three delivery pockets were empty for a good reason. A small signal bell beside the porch made only a muffled hiss when its cord moved.

The Bell That Hissed

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 13

Fern Lodge's reply sack was waiting. Its signal bell was not doing nearly as well. A loose cloth edge lay against the clapper. Nib blew at it with a magnificent puff, and the bell answered with the faintest possible hiss. Lark found the stand's short instruction.

“A very quiet bell,” Nib whispered suspiciously. “A bell wearing a scarf,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **pack**

“In bell and fill, the two l letters share one /l/ sound,” Lark explained clearly. “Puff ends with one /f/ written ff. Hiss ends with one /s/ written ss. We still blend the sounds once each; extra letters don't ask for extra little vowels.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try puff, fill, bell, hiss. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read bell on the stand note,” Lark invited gently. “Which part needs room to move?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can fill. Pat can puff.**

“Which friend can puff?” Lark asked warmly. “Look at the word after can in each sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib lifted the loose cloth and fixed it clear of the clapper. The bell rang once. They collected Fern Lodge's reply from the agreed hook. On the return path they used their own notes: the Mill reply waited in its letter bin, and Reed Hut's reply waited in its flap. Three replies settled into three separate bag pockets.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write bell beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The cloth stayed clear and the bell stayed useful. With every invitation delivered and every reply collected, the crew followed the familiar dry path back to camp. Nothing was still waiting at an unvisited stop.

The First Post Round

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 2, Episode 14

At camp, Nib lifted a flag above the new post rack. Lark laid the three replies beneath it. Before they celebrated, each reply needed its destination beside it, and the route book needed the details another courier would actually use. The flag could wait while the record became clear.

“Delivered. Returned. Remembered,” Nib declared with satisfaction. “Ready for someone else to follow,” Lark added warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **puff**

“In stamp, keep the beginning sounds close: /s/, /t/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Don't slip a vowel between them. Join the rest, then read step the same way. All the familiar sounds keep their jobs when consonants stand side by side.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try stamp, tent, flag, step. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the rack labels and our return notes,” Lark invited warmly. “Which destination belongs with each reply?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can stamp. Pat can step.**

“Who can stamp?” Lark asked gently. “Which friend has the other job?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark supplied the place names while you checked the short labels and route pictures. Reed Hut's flap, the Mill bin, and Fern Lodge's sack hook matched the three pockets. Nib set the flag above a rack that now told the whole story. Neighbors arrived to use the library, and a little post horn joined your collection.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write stamp beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Nib gave the horn one cheerful note. Lark bound fourteen journal chapters into Through the Woods. The post circuit was working: three invitations out, three replies home. One reply invited a later visit to Lookout Hill. Tonight, the second book stood finished beside the first.

The Tree Beyond the Trees

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 1

Lookout Hill's invitation lay beside a borrowed guide. The woodland post route was working behind you; the complete old map and moonstone remained at camp. On the hill path, Nib chose the first convenient tree. Lark compared its rounded crown with the forked silhouette in the guide. They were plainly different trees.

“A tree is a tree,” Nib declared hopefully. “This word asks us to see a particular one,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **stamp**

“Two e letters can work together for the long e sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read see and seed with one vowel sound for ee. Compare the short e in pen. In tree, blend the beginning sounds together before adding ee.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try see, seed, feet, tree. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tree in the route key,” Lark invited gently. “Which distant silhouette matches the whole guide clue?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can see. Pat can see tree tops.**

“What can Pat see?” Lark asked gently. “Read all the words after can.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

From a broad viewing stump, the forked tree showed above the near canopy. Lark traced the correct path in the guide. Nib stepped away from his convenient trunk and followed the useful direction instead. At a supply shelter, the lookout's glass fittings waited in padded storage. They had found the route without inventing a new map.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write see beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the two tree shapes on your first hill journal page. The guide stayed with the crew. The next job was bringing the waiting glass and its small fittings uphill in one piece.

The Jammed Jar

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 2

At the supply shelter, tiny fixing pieces rested inside a clean reused jar. Its lid was jammed. Nib twisted until the whole jar turned in his paws. Lark put a padded tray beneath it before the little fittings could be tipped onto the floor.

“A jar with a very firm opinion,” Nib muttered suspiciously. “Let us give it a gentler suggestion,” Lark urged.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **see**

“Lowercase j begins jam and job,” Lark modeled clearly. “Make its one quick voiced sound, /j/, without an extra vowel. Join j, a, m for jam. The word can describe what is happening here even though this jar holds fittings rather than a picnic spread.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try jam, jet, jog, job. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the short job label,” Lark invited gently. “Then use the supplied diagram to choose pressing and lifting instead of tipping.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can jog. Pat can get jam.**

“Who can get jam?” Lark asked warmly. “Which friend has the different job?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The jar rested in the tray's padded recess. Nib pressed the stiff catch and lifted the lid while Lark held the tray steady. No little pieces spilled. They sorted the fittings into separate shallow spaces and closed the tray. A larger glass pane still waited nearby; that load needed a wheeled carrier rather than a mouse carrying everything at once.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write j beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the jar sitting safely in its recess. Outside the shelter stood a small woodland delivery van with space for a padded load. The fittings were ready to travel with the glass.

The Van with the Wrong Load

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 3

Two crates waited beside the delivery van. Nib loaded the largest first. When its lid lifted, velvet flags spilled over the edge. The glass pane remained in a smaller padded tray on the shelter floor. Lark unfolded the reserved-load strip from the lookout guide.

“Very valuable velvet flags,” Nib announced eagerly. “Very useful glass,” Lark replied firmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **jam**

“For v, touch top teeth to lower lip and add your voice: /v/,” Lark modeled clearly. “For f, the air flows without that voice. Compare van and fan. Our new v keeps its voice as we join it into van and vest.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try van, vet, vest. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read van on the reserved-load strip,” Lark invited gently. “Which pictured load does that whole strip assign to our journey?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can get it. Pat can not.**

“Which friend cannot get it?” Lark asked gently. “Read the whole second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib returned the decorations to the shelter. The glass tray settled into the van's padded supports, with the fittings secured separately beside it. Lark checked that neither could slide across the other. The correct load was smaller and considerably more useful. The van reached a covered stopping place just as a shower began.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write v beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the actual load, then supplied the little missing spoken words when rereading the journal together. The glass was safely uphill, but its case cover stopped short of the lower edge. The rain had found the next practical question.

A Cape for the Case

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 4

The glass case rested beneath the stopping-place roof. Nib wrapped a spare cover around it until even the handle disappeared. It was beautifully covered and impossible to carry. Rain brushed the roof edge while Lark laid the guide open where it stayed dry.

“A cape of considerable elegance,” Nib declared. “A handle of considerable usefulness,” Lark observed warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **van**

“Compare cap and cape,” Lark modeled clearly. “In cape, a and the final silent e work across the middle consonant to give a its long sound. Tap becomes tape the same way. The little word a is special: here we say it softly, /uh/, before a name for something. We'll learn that word explicitly, too.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cape, tape, make, a. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tape on the fitting note,” Lark invited gently. “Where does the diagram leave room for the handle?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can make a cape. Pat can tape it.**

“What can Pat do after Sam makes the cape?” Lark asked warmly. “Use the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib opened the unnecessary top fold. Lark held a fitted cloth cape around the case while he fixed its lower edge with tape. The rain could run off, and the handle stayed free. They tested a short lift before returning the covered case to its padded place. At the narrow approach ahead, a short stopping note waited.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write cape beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The journal picture showed both the dry case and its usable handle. Nib carried the light guide while the van brought the covered glass onward. The next support was visible, but not ready to cross.

The Yes That Meant Yet

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 5

Nib saw the first letters of a stopping note and brightened. The van waited behind him on broad ground. Ahead, one fastening on the crossing support was still loose. Lark put a wing beside the very last letter before Nib could call the route ready.

“Yes!” Nib exclaimed. “Yet,” Lark corrected gently, pointing to the very last letter.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cape**

“At the beginning of yes and yet, y has its consonant sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Join it to e and s for yes. Now change only the last sound to t: yet. The beginning doesn't tell us enough to choose between them.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try yes, yet, yap. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the final word on our stopping note,” Lark invited gently. “Does it say yes, or yet?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can yap. Pat can not nap yet.**

“Who cannot nap yet?” Lark asked gently. “What is Sam doing in the other sentence?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The longer message, supplied by Lark, was not yet. Nib stayed behind the support while its visible fastening was secured. Lark checked the supported boards, and the van crossed slowly only when the load path was ready. On the far side, a duck greeted you beside the next marker with an enthusiastic quack.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write y beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the two ending letters side by side. The load was safely across, and waiting had finished its useful job. Nib listened to the duck's greeting without pretending it was permission for the next turn.

A Quack Beside the Path

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 6

The duck quacked beside two sheltered notes. One marked a rest bay; the other showed the direct path to the hill lodging. Nib nodded politely at every quack and nearly turned in three directions at once. Lark held the guide still so the printed clue could have a turn.

“Very clear quacking,” Nib insisted politely. “A useful word is clearer still,” Lark murmured.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **yes**

“Here qu writes the two familiar sounds /k/ and /w/ close together,” Lark modeled clearly. “Blend them into quack and quick. It isn't the letter name, and it isn't one new sound. Queen uses the ee team we already met.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try quit, quick, quack, queen. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read quack on the route label,” Lark invited gently. “Match it to the duck marker, then check where its path leads.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can quack. Pat can quit.**

“Which friend can stop?” Lark asked warmly. “Find the word that tells you.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The duck marker belonged beside the direct lodging path. Nib waved goodbye and followed the note rather than the loudest greeting. The van reached a level parking space below the hill lodging. The covered glass and fittings were intact. A fixed lifting frame stood beside the platform above, ready for the final part of their journey.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write quack beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the duck's marker and the lodging turn. Nib parked the van before studying the lifting frame. The correct path was found, and now the glass needed a proper lifting attachment.

The Rope at the Hill Home

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 7

At the hill lodging, Nib looped a rope around the cloth cape. Lark stopped the lift before the cloth took the weight. The case rested securely below the fixed frame. Its real load points were visible beneath the handle, exactly where the guide's sling diagram showed them.

“A strong cape,” Nib suggested hopefully. “A stronger place to hold it,” Lark urged calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **quit**

“In rope and note, o and final silent e give the vowel its long sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare hop with hope, then read rope. We don't use a long o every time we see o; the spelling of the whole word helps us choose.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try rope, home, note. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read rope on the proper sling's label,” Lark invited gently. “Which attachment points does the guide give it?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can get a rope. Pat can make a note.**

“Who can record something in writing?” Lark asked gently. “Which word tells you?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the loop from the cover to the case's load points. They raised it a small distance, checked the sling, and lowered it once before the full lift. The frame brought the glass onto the fixed platform intact. The cape stayed a cover. Unfortunately, the packing box's opening now faced the platform rail.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write rope beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The journal showed the sling beneath the case rather than squeezing its cape. Lark parked the lifting gear. The glass had reached its destination safely; opening the supported box would take one more careful look.

The Box Facing Backward

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 8

Nib lifted the packing lid a little. Its hinge caught against the platform rail. He lowered it without forcing the wood. The box was perfectly good, but it faced the wrong way. Lark put the guide beside it so both hinge arrangements could be compared.

“A box with its back in the way,” Nib complained mildly. “A box we can turn,” Lark replied brightly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **rope**

“At the end of box, x represents /k/ followed by /s/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Two sounds, one letter here. Read box, fox, and six, keeping those ending sounds close. Don't insert an extra vowel between them.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try box, fox, six. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read box on the fitting diagram,” Lark invited gently. “Which side needs clear space for the lid?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

Sam can fix a box. Pat can see a fox.

“Who sees an animal?” Lark asked softly. “Which final word gives you that clue?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

They turned the supported box until its hinge matched the diagram. Nib opened the lid fully without touching the rail. Lark and the caretaker fitted the glass into its prepared frame. The empty packaging stayed on the platform floor. A flexible ventilation strip lay beside its groove, ready to fit before the lantern was lit.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write box beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the same box in a more useful position. Nothing had needed breaking. The glass now belonged to the lantern's frame, and the next small fitting would help air pass through its vent.

The Zigzag Strip

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 9

The ventilation strip stopped halfway along its zigzag groove. Nib pulled. Its fold tightened. Lark held the strip loosely against the platform so they could inspect the bend without another tug. The new glass stood protected in its frame beside them.

“It has a very zigzag opinion,” Nib muttered suspiciously. “Let us follow the bend,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **box**

“Lowercase z makes the voiced buzz in zip,” Lark modeled clearly. “Now these familiar-looking s letters need explicit attention: in is and has, s also says /z/. Join each word with that sound. This doesn't change the s in sit into a buzz.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try zip, zap, is, has. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read is and has on the checking strip,” Lark invited gently. “Then use the groove picture to decide whether to follow its bend or pull straight.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam has a box. A red zip is on it.**

“Where is the red zip?” Lark asked gently. “Use the two sentences together to explain what it means.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib eased the trapped fold backward. Together they followed the groove's actual zigzag, settling one catch at a time. The strip fitted without stretching, and air could pass through the fixed vent. Lark marked that job complete. The window still needed aligning to its intended direction.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write zip beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the strip following its groove. Nib tested the vent once more and left it alone. Across the platform floor, several old scratches competed with one proper reference line.

The Line Across the Floor

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 10

Nib chose the longest scratch on the platform floor. If the window followed it, the lantern would point straight into the roof. Lark checked the guide. Its reference ran from the window post to a fixed floor peg, a much shorter line with a much more useful destination.

“A very long line,” Nib declared. “The right line,” Lark replied with quiet determination.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

zip

“Compare pin and pine,” Lark modeled clearly. “The final silent e helps i make its long sound in pine and line. The pronoun I is a whole word with that same long sound; it means the person speaking. We'll read it explicitly before using it.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try line, pine, time, I. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read line in the guide,” Lark invited gently. “Which line joins the two fixed points in its diagram?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can see a pine. Sam can see a line.**

“What can Sam see?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence names him rather than the speaker?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib put his paw beside the fixed peg. Lark aligned the window frame to the matching reference. The intended path now led out toward the community meeting place, rather than into the roof. They secured the frame. When the shutter moved, a connecting ring rattled against its pin and stopped the motion short.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write line beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the fixed peg as well as the line. Nib left the old scratches where they were. The window's direction was settled; the loose ring was now the one remaining reason the shutter could not move smoothly.

The Ring That Rang

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 11

The connecting ring made a pleasant little clang. Nib tested it again, enjoying the note until the shutter stopped halfway open. Lark showed him where the retaining pin had slipped from its proper seat. The music had come from a joint that needed fastening.

“A ring that rings,” Nib observed delightedly. “A ring that stays on,” Lark reminded him warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **line**

“In ring and sing, ng writes the single sound /ng/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Keep the ending smooth. Don't add a separate hard g after it. Compare pin and ring, listening to how their endings differ.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try ring, sing, long, king. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read ring on the joint note,” Lark invited gently. “Which fastening belongs to that ring?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

I can sing. Sam has a ring.

“Who has a ring?” Lark asked softly. “Does the passage say that both people have one?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib held the unloaded ring still while Lark seated the retaining pin. They tested one small shutter movement. The ring stayed connected, and the shutter completed its travel without a clang. The caretaker brought the next fitting: a long tube meant to carry an ordinary signal chime toward the meeting place.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write ring beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the secured joint. Nib listened to its new silence with approval. The shutter worked; the chime still needed a tube that pointed toward the people who were meant to hear it.

The Tune in the Tube

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 12

Nib heard a beautiful note through the newly fitted tube. Outside, Lark heard almost nothing. The open end faced the wall. The fitting had made a splendid private concert for one mouse, while the meeting place remained quiet.

“Excellent music in here,” Nib reported proudly. “We would like some of it out there,” Lark replied with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **ring**

“In cube and mule, u with final silent e can say /yoo/,” Lark modeled clearly. “In flute it says /oo/. Tube may have either familiar pronunciation in ordinary speech. We'll model the word as we say it here, then join its parts without changing its meaning.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cube, mule, tube, flute. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tube on the fitting note,” Lark invited warmly. “Which way does the open-end picture face?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam has a tube. I can make a tune.**

“What does Sam have?” Lark asked gently. “What can the speaker make?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

They loosened the supported fitting and turned the open end toward the listening area. Nib secured it while Lark checked the diagram. One short chime now reached the meeting place. The tube stayed fixed to its bracket; no mysterious sound source had appeared. A cloth shade still covered part of the light window.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write tube beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed sound traveling through the ordinary open tube. The chime was ready. Lark kept the lantern unlit while the shade's snag was inspected beside the new glass.

The Shade That Would Not Shift

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 13

The cloth shade caught at the edge of its channel. Nib began to push beside the glass, then noticed how little room his paw had. Lark found the shade's own handle in the guide picture. It was meant to move the shade without pressing on the pane.

“A shade with a stubborn edge,” Nib whispered suspiciously. “A handle with a useful job,” Lark replied calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cube**

“In shut and shade, s and h work together for one /sh/ sound,” Lark modeled softly. “Don't split the team into /s/ and /h/. Join sh, u, t for shut. Shade keeps the long a pattern we already know.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try shut, ship, shop, shade. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read shut on the guide strip,” Lark invited gently. “Which handle does its picture give the shade?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can shut a box. Sam can see a ship.**

“Who can see a ship?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes closing something?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark freed the little catch while Nib used the proper handle. The shade slid through its clear channel without scraping the glass. The caretaker lit the ordinary lantern inside its fixed housing. The crew left the shutter shut until the agreed signal was ready. Vent, frame, ring, tube, and shade now each did their own job.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write shut beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the clear channel and safe handle. Nib kept his paw away from the glass. The lantern was prepared, and the invitation still held the simple signal the neighbors were waiting for.

My First Beacon

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 14

The invitation lay open beside the completed lantern. It asked for one steady light and one short chime to mark the community gathering. Nib looked from the working fittings to the waiting meeting place. Every small repair had helped make this final signal possible.

“My first beacon,” Nib whispered proudly. “Our neighbors’ useful light,” Lark added warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **shut**

“At the ends of my, by, and fly, y can say long i,” Lark modeled clearly. “That is a different job from y at the start of yes. Read these whole words, then revisit lift, shut, and tap on our prepared instruction strip.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try my, by, fly. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the agreed signal instructions,” Lark invited warmly. “Which job opens the light, and how many chimes does the invitation ask for?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can fly by a pine. My ring is in a box.**

“Where is the ring?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us, rather than telling us about flying?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib used the prepared handle while the shade lifted. Steady light reached the aligned window. One short chime followed. At the meeting place, a flag waved in reply. The signal had reached its intended readers and listeners. After the gathering, the borrowed guide returned to its keeper. A brass star badge and an ordinary viewing lens joined the explorer kit.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write my beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark bound The Long Path and carried it home to the library. The fixed lantern stayed useful on Lookout Hill. A separate Storyboat invitation arrived with returning visitors. The hill adventure was complete before a new voyage began.

A Seat for a Sea Tale

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 1

Four requests lay beside four books on the new Storyboat. The original ferry still had its own job elsewhere. This boat would bring library loans to Commons, Reed Creek, Farm Quay, and Mill Pond. Nib placed a splendid spare seat directly across the deck walkway. Lark stopped with the first book in her wings.

“A magnificent seat,” Nib announced. “A magnificent place to walk past it,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **my**

“In sea and seat, ea writes long e,” Lark modeled clearly. “It can sound like ee in see. Read sea, then add the ending sound for seat. We learn this spelling from these examples; other ea words may need different help.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sea, seat, team. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read seat on the deck plan,” Lark invited gently. “Which supported place leaves the walkway clear?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A team can see a seat. A seat is on a mat.**

“Who can see a seat?” Lark asked gently. “Where does the second sentence put it?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the seat onto its marked supports. Lark packed Sea in the first dry compartment for Commons. Three other requested books went into separate compartments, their titles supplied aloud. The deck route stayed open. The lending record began with four requests and no loans yet completed.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write seat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your first boat journal page showed a clear walkway. Before leaving, the crew needed to fit the dry chest's lid so it could open without striking the newly placed seat.

The Chest with Two Hinges

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 2

The chest lid rose and bumped the seat. Nib lowered it before it could scratch the wood. Its reversible hinge had been fitted on the walkway side. The four requested books remained dry in their compartments while Lark checked the fitting sketch.

“An enthusiastic lid,” Nib muttered. “A lid that needs room,” Lark replied calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sea**

“Ch writes the single sound at the beginning of chip and chest,” Lark modeled clearly. “It differs from the flowing sh in ship. Read chip and chest, keeping each letter team together. Bench has that same ch sound at its end.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try chip, chest, bench. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read chest on the fitting sketch,” Lark invited gently. “Which hinge side leaves space for both lid and seat?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A chest is shut. A bench is by it.**

“What is beside the chest?” Lark asked gently. “Does the passage say the chest is open?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib laid the lid flat on a supported work board. Lark held it while he moved the hinge pins to the correct side. Once refitted, the lid opened into clear space. The seat stayed secure, the walkway stayed usable, and the books stayed dry. At Commons, the first landing ramp waited above its proper support slot.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write chest beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the corrected hinges in your journal. A lid could be enthusiastic without hitting anything now. The next job was making the ramp as useful to the cart as the chest was to the books.

The Ramp by the Cart

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 3

The small book cart caught at the ramp's raised end. Nib pushed once and made it more firmly stuck. Lark noticed the unused lower support slot at the landing. Sea waited safely in the cart; the other three books remained aboard.

“A cart is excellent at going,” Nib grumbled mildly. “A ramp helps with where,” Lark observed.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **chip**

“Ar gives the vowel sound in cart,” Lark modeled clearly. “Hear it as a joined part rather than a short a followed by a new syllable. Read cart, farm, and park with the pronunciation we use in speech.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cart, farm, park. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read cart on the load diagram,” Lark invited gently. “Which slot puts its ramp against a real support?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

A cart is on a ramp. Sam can park it.

“What can Sam park?” Lark asked gently. “Use the first sentence to explain it.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib backed the cart onto the level deck. Together they lowered the ramp into the proper slot and tested its seating. Lark steadied the side while Nib rolled the cart ashore. The wheels crossed the join smoothly. The Commons borrower waited near a supported shelf with two fern-marked papers beside it.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write cart beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the supported ramp join. Sea had reached Commons, but the loan still needed the correct borrower and record. Arriving at a shelf was not the same as finishing the handoff.

The Fern on the Return Slip

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 4

Two papers bore a fern emblem. Nib held them side by side as if matching pictures settled everything. One was a current borrowing slip. The other was an old direction note. Sea rested on the cart while Lark checked what each page was for.

“Two ferns, one book,” Nib reported anxiously. “One current borrowing slip,” Lark replied carefully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cart**

“In fern, er works as a vowel spelling,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read her, fern, and stern using the sound in our ordinary speech. Knowing fern doesn't tell us which paper is current; the borrower picture and date space give different information.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try her, fern, stern. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read fern, then compare the two slips,” Lark invited gently. “Which one records this borrower and today's loan?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A fern is by a cart. Her cap is on a shelf.**

“Where is the cap?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes the plant instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark supplied the date and place names. The current slip matched the waiting borrower's shelf. Nib placed Sea there, and Lark entered the loan once in the record. The old direction note stayed out of the lending ledger. One book was lent; Moon, Train, and Phone remained aboard for their later stops.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write fern beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The Commons shelf kept Sea for its agreed loan time. Your boat turned toward the next bend, where a rope route passed too close to a bird's fixed perch.

The Bird and the Turn

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 5

A bird sat quietly above the first mooring post. Nib held the rope and considered whether the bird might prefer another branch. Lark found a second low post within the boat's safe reach. The bird's perch could remain exactly where it was.

“The bird has chosen an inconvenient branch,” Nib complained softly. “We can choose another post,” Lark replied kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **her**

“Ir in bird and ur in turn can spell the vowel we already met in fern,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read bird, turn, and fur. Similar sounds can have different spellings, so we look at the actual letters instead of swapping them in our minds.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try bird, turn, fur. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read turn on the mooring note,” Lark invited gently. “Which post lets the rope turn without entering the perch space?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A bird can turn. Its wing is by a fern.**

“What is beside the fern?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence lets you check?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib brought the rope around the lower post while keeping its boat end attached. Lark checked the line from deck to shore. The boat settled securely at the bend, the cart route stayed clear, and the bird kept its comfortable branch. Ahead, two paths led toward Reed Creek's reading bank.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write turn beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the second post on your route page. Nobody needed to move the bird to make the boat safe. Now the crew could inspect the narrow path and the broad cart route from solid ground.

The Thin Path

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 6

The shorter path to Reed Creek was thin and raised. The longer path was broad, with room for the cart's wheels. Nib admired how quickly his feet could reach the narrow path's far end. Lark looked at the cart behind him and the walking-only picture on the route card.

“A short path,” Nib exclaimed hopefully. “A thin path,” Lark reminded him gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **bird**

“In thin and path, th writes one breathy sound,” Lark modeled softly. “Let air pass gently with your tongue near your teeth, without voice. Read thin, path, and bath. A different voiced th will have its own lesson; we aren't treating every th alike today.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try thin, path, bath. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read thin on the route card,” Lark invited gently. “Which path does the picture allow our cart to use?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **A thin path is by a farm. Sam can see it.**

“What can Sam see?” Lark asked softly. “Use the first sentence to explain it.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark scouted the thin path briefly on the wing. It reached the bank, but it had not grown wider. Nib brought the cart along the broad supported path instead. Both friends arrived at Reed Creek with the books intact. Two neighboring signs pointed toward opposite banks.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write thin beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the cart's actual route. A short way could be useful to feet and still be wrong for wheels. At the reading bank, the crew needed to decide which of the two signs was current.

This Bank, That Bank

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 7

Nib began arranging the reading mat beneath an old sign with splendid painted curls. Across the landing, a newer note pointed toward a reachable shelf. Lark laid the current landing picture beside both directions. One matched the place where your boat could actually stop.

“That sign has splendid curls,” Nib argued. “This bank has our landing,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **thin**

“In this, that, and then, th uses voice,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare it with the breathy beginning of thin. The little word the has voiced th too, with a soft weak vowel in this sentence. We'll model the whole word before asking you to read it.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try this, that, then, the. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read this bank on the current note,” Lark invited gently. “Which real landing matches its picture?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **This is the path. The cart is on that path.**

“Where is the cart?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the portable mat to the bank identified by the current note. Lark fixed a clear updated sign there and marked the old direction as out of date. The reading place now matched the reachable shelf. Moon stayed aboard until its support was ready; choosing a bank had not yet completed the loan.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write this beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the actual landing on your journal page. Nib admired the older sign's curls one last time, then turned to the book request. The reader had asked for Moon, whatever the prettiest cover might show.

The Moon Book

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 8

Several closed books showed pale circles against dark skies. Nib chose the largest circle, delighted with its moonlike roundness. Lark held the borrower's request beside the actual title. Moon was a word as well as a picture, and only one of these covers carried that title.

“A very moon-shaped moon,” Nib insisted. “A word that says Moon,” Lark replied with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **this**

“Oo in moon and pool writes the long /oo/ sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Join m, oo, n. The short words to and do have this sound with a single o; those special spellings need their own explicit model. We won't guess them from the ordinary short o.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try moon, pool, to, do. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Moon on the closed covers,” Lark invited gently. “Which title matches the request?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The moon is up. I can get to the pool.**

“Where can the speaker go?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence gives a destination?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib returned the other books to their compartments. Moon came to the chosen Reed Creek landing. When he put it on a temporary round support, its lower edge began to slide. He caught it gently. The right book had arrived, but lending it still needed a stable reading rest and a completed record.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write moon beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the correct title. Lark kept Moon supported in her wings while Nib inspected the round rest. The next solution would need a broad foot rather than another beautiful circle.

The Book That Would Not Stay

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 9

The round support rolled beneath Moon. Nib tried holding the book with his nose, then discovered he could not turn a page. Lark lowered it onto the flat landing mat. The fitting diagram showed a wooden foot for the rest, waiting in the boat's small parts tray.

“A good book needs a good place to be a book,” Nib observed solemnly. “This one has one now,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **moon**

“Oo has a different sound in book, look, and foot,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare book with moon. We'll learn and practice each whole example rather than assuming one oo sound fits every word. Read foot on the fitting sketch after listening.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try book, look, foot. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read foot,” Lark invited gently. “Which broad part belongs under the unstable rest?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The book is on the rest. Its foot is on the mat.**

“What supports the book rest in our little passage?” Lark asked gently. “Look back at the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib fitted the broad foot against the rest's base. The angled surface stayed still. Lark placed Moon on it and opened a page without needing anyone's nose. The Reed Creek borrower received the book, and Lark entered the second loan once. Train and Phone remained aboard for Farm Quay and Mill Pond.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write book beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Moon stayed with its borrower for the agreed time. Your boat left Reed Creek with two loans completed. At the next bend, a mooring line had wandered into the cart's route across the deck.

The Rope Around the Bow

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 10

Nib secured the mooring and found that the cart would not move. The rope ran through its handle space. The boat was tied, but so was the book cart. Lark kept the boat end attached while studying the route diagram for the line.

“The cart is very securely moored,” Nib admitted ruefully. “Let us moor the boat,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **book**

“Ou in out and ow in cow can write the same moving vowel sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read out, cow, and brown. The title's word bow needs its own spoken meaning from me today; we don't have to guess an unfamiliar use from a familiar-looking team.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try out, cow, brown. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read out on the diagram,” Lark invited gently. “Where should the line pass in relation to the cart route?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The brown cow is out. A book is on the cart.**

“What is outside?” Lark asked softly. “Which sentence describes the animal?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the loose section outside the cart's travel space and around the proper bow fitting. The boat end stayed attached throughout the change. Lark checked the mooring before the cart rolled again. At Farm Quay, the next request card showed a railway picture and the title of the book its reader wanted.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write out beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the boat held steady and the cart free. Two useful jobs no longer competed for the same space. The Farm Quay request could now be prepared without an accidental rope around its delivery cart.

The Train for Another Day

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 11

Train had a splendid folding railway picture. Nib wanted to put it on display at once. The Farm Quay request assigned that very book to a waiting borrower. Lark set the display tray beside the next-delivery tray so the difference could be seen as well as read.

“An excellent day for a train,” Nib exclaimed. “And a reader who requested one,” Lark added kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **out**

“Ai in train and rain writes long a,” Lark modeled clearly. “Ay in day and play can write that same sound. Compare them with a and silent e in make. The sound can match while the actual spelling stays different.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try train, rain, day, play. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Train on the request,” Lark invited gently. “Which tray serves the reader who asked for it?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The train is in the rain. I can play by the cart.**

“What is in the rain?” Lark asked gently. “Find the subject of the first sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib placed Train in the next-delivery tray and left the display book in its own place. The loan remained unrecorded while the boat approached Farm Quay. At the landing, an old direction board pointed toward closed bank stairs. A newer note showed a floating pontoon with an attached ramp.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write train beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew Train ready for its reader. The impressive foldout could wait to open in the right hands. First, the crew needed to use Farm Quay's current landing rather than its old closed stairs.

The Boat on the Note

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 12

The bank stair was roped closed. Beside it floated a broad pontoon, joined to shore by a ramp attached at both ends. Nib compared the old and new notes. Their boat pictures looked different because the landing itself had changed.

“The note has changed its boat,” Nib murmured suspiciously. “The landing changed first,” Lark explained gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **train**

“Oa in boat and coat writes long o,” Lark modeled clearly. “Ow can write long o in snow, a different sound from ow in cow. Read each example and check its meaning. We don't decide that a spelling always has its first learned sound.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try boat, coat, snow. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read boat on the current note,” Lark invited gently. “Which diagram matches the attached pontoon we can actually see?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The boat is by the dock. My coat is on the seat.**

“Where is the coat?” Lark asked softly. “Which sentence gives that information?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The boat reached the usable pontoon. Its ramp moved gently with the water while both attachments stayed secure. Nib checked the support before bringing Train toward shore. The borrower still needed the proper lending token, so the third entry remained pending in the record.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write boat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the current pontoon drawing. The old stairs stayed closed. At the quay's lending table, a coin-shaped token and a bright toy token waited for different purposes.

The Coin and the Toy

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 13

Nib admired the bright toy token on Farm Quay's table. A plain coin-shaped token lay beside the current borrowing slip. The toy belonged to another activity. Lark held Train's request next to the lending instructions while the book remained safely on its cart.

“A joyful toy,” Nib declared hopefully. “A useful coin-shaped token,” Lark replied with a smile.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **boat**

“Oi in coin and join writes the same vowel sound as oy in toy,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read coin and toy right through. Similar sounds don't make the objects interchangeable; their words and the instructions tell us their different jobs.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try coin, toy, join. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read coin on the lending instruction,” Lark invited gently. “Which token belongs with this borrowing slip?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The coin is by the toy. I can join the team.**

“Which two things are beside each other?” Lark asked gently. “Does the other sentence describe an object or a person joining?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib attached the coin-shaped lending token to Train's current slip. The toy stayed on its own activity tray. The borrower's identity and request now matched, but a hauling strap still stretched across the cart's exit. Lark kept the book aboard until that route was clear.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write coin beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the token check without marking the loan finished. Your journal showed the correct slip ready. One taut strap still had to leave the route before Train could reach its borrower.

The Haul Across the Lawn

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 14

The quay's unloaded hauling strap crossed the exit at handle height. Nib tried easing the cart under it. His handle caught immediately. Lark followed the strap back to its low storage hook, where it should have rested between hauling jobs.

“A strap has borrowed my handle,” Nib complained mildly. “We can give it its own hook,” Lark suggested.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **coin**

“Aw in saw and claw, and au in haul, write the modeled vowel sound in our speech,” Lark explained clearly. “Some speakers pronounce these vowels differently from others. We'll listen to our own clear examples, join their parts, and keep their meanings in view.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try saw, haul, claw. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read haul on the strap note,” Lark invited gently. “Where does its storage picture put the unloaded strap?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I saw the cart. The team can haul it.**

“What can the team haul?” Lark asked softly. “Use the first sentence to explain it.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib backed the cart away. Lark released the unloaded strap from the crossing hook, and Nib settled it onto its own low storage hook. The cart's whole route was clear. Train and its lending token could now travel together toward the supported borrower shelf.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write haul beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The journal showed the strap put away rather than stretched across a doorway. The hauling tool was ready for its next proper job. Your current job was finally bringing Train to the right shelf at the quay fork.

The Fork at the Port

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 15

Two low shelves stood at the port fork. One held workshop notices. The other was marked for current borrowers. Nib could see shore on both sides, but only one shelf matched Train's slip. Lark kept the token and book together while checking the last part of the handoff.

“More shores than I expected,” Nib remarked. “One borrower on this shore,” Lark replied carefully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

saw

“Or in fork and corn, and ore in shore, represent the modeled sound in these words,” Lark explained clearly. “Read each with our ordinary pronunciation. A word like shore has familiar sh at the start and its own prepared vowel spelling at the end.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try fork, corn, shore. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the prepared shore label,” Lark invited gently. “Which shelf matches the actual borrower's slip rather than the workshop notice?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The fork is by the shore. The corn is on the cart.**

“Where is the corn?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us about the cart?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Train reached the supported borrower shelf with its coin-shaped token. Lark entered the third loan exactly once. Sea remained at Commons and Moon at Reed Creek; nobody reclaimed those books to refill the boat. Phone was now the sole requested book still aboard. The boat turned toward Mill Pond.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write shore beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal marked Farm Quay complete. Nib could enjoy the idea of the foldout train reaching its reader. At Mill Pond, a record board had small cells for receipts and a separate tray for money.

The Cell for the Receipt

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 16

Nib began arranging the record board by shininess. The cent tray looked important, and a paper receipt looked rather plain. Lark set the current slip beside the board's empty receipt cell. Phone remained aboard until its reading place and borrower were ready.

“A cent in a cell?” Nib asked suspiciously. “A receipt in this cell,” Lark clarified gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **fork**

“C can say /s/ before e, i, or y in examples like cent and cell,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare that with /k/ in cap. Read cent, cell, and ice using the sound we have explicitly modeled for each. These examples help us read the actual label.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cent, cell, ice. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read cell on the record board,” Lark invited gently. “Where does the current receipt belong?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The cent is in the tray. The slip is in the cell.**

“Where is the slip?” Lark asked softly. “Which item stays in the tray?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib placed the receipt in its own cell and left coins in the money tray. The borrowing record was prepared without turning a receipt into a new loan. At the waiting reading rest, one short foot still needed a soft support pad before Phone could be set down.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write cell beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the two storage places in your journal. Records and money now had different homes. The last reading rest needed something practical beneath its short foot, whatever its shape might resemble.

The Gem-Shaped Pad

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 17

A glittering gem-shaped decoration and a soft gel pad had similar outlines. Nib chose the glittering one for the reading rest. It looked magnificent and rocked beneath the short foot. Lark brought the supplies note closer before anyone placed a book on top.

“A gem of a solution,” Nib exclaimed proudly. “A gel solution,” Lark corrected with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cent**

“G can say /j/ in gem and gel,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare the hard g in get, which keeps its own sound. Read gem and gel through their different last letters. The soft sound is prepared in these examples; we won't change every g we meet.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try gem, gel, age. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read gel on the supply note,” Lark invited gently. “Which material can settle beneath the short foot?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The gel is by the gem. I can get the gel.**

“Which thing can the speaker get?” Lark asked gently. “Read its last sound carefully.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib returned the gem to the decoration tray. The gel pad compressed beneath the rest's short foot, and the broad top stayed level. Lark tested it with a light touch before putting anything valuable there. Phone remained in the boat while the borrower's message tube was checked.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write gel beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the useful pad beside the steady foot. Sparkle had not been the feature the rest needed. At the speaking tube, two wheels opened two different fittings, and the next note identified the right one.

Which Wheel to Turn

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 18

One wheel opened the speaking tube. The other opened a small shelf shutter. Nib turned the prettier wheel and found himself looking at an unrelated panel. Lark closed it gently and held the borrower's note beside the actual tube bracket.

“Which wheel is wonderfully round?” Nib wondered aloud. “Which wheel opens our tube?” Lark asked patiently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **gem**

“Wh begins when and wheel,” Lark modeled clearly. “Some families say it like w, and some keep a breathier sound. We'll use the way we speak. Why has the final y sound we already know. Read the examples without inventing an extra syllable.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try when, wheel, why. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read wheel on the note,” Lark invited gently. “Which pictured wheel opens the tube where we are meant to listen?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **When can I turn the wheel? The note has it.**

“What can answer the speaker's question?” Lark asked gently. “Find it in the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib turned the correct wheel. The ordinary tube carried the waiting borrower's message clearly. Lark read back the confirmed request: Phone, the illustrated story of woodland messages. The book shelf stayed closed until that confirmation was complete. No fifth request had appeared.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write wheel beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the confirmed borrower. The steady reading rest was ready, the receipt cell was prepared, and one requested book remained to be selected by its actual title.

The Phone Book at the Pond

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 19

The last tray held several books with circles and bright lines on their covers. Lark kept the confirmed request beside them. Nib looked at each title before admiring the pictures. The waiting reader had asked for the history of messages called Phone.

“A phone with paper pages,” Nib murmured, delighted. “A story about messages,” Lark explained warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **when**

“Ph can write /f/ in phone and graph,” Lark modeled clearly. “The sound is familiar from fan, but this spelling needs its own model. Join ph with the long o pattern in phone. Keep the letter team together rather than sounding p and h separately.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try phone, graph. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read Phone on the closed covers,” Lark invited warmly. “Which title matches the confirmed request?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The phone is by the book. I can make a graph.**

“What can the speaker make?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence is about the phone instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib carried the selected book to the stable rest. Lark placed its current slip with the prepared receipt and entered the fourth loan once. All four requested books now had borrowers, destinations, and records. The Storyboat turned toward home with its lending job complete.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write phone beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed Phone on its borrowed reading rest. The four loans stayed with their readers for their agreed times. The boat could return to its berth for a celebration that matched the real lending record.

The First Storyboat Round

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 20

Four flags waited beside the berth. Nib wanted to raise them together. Lark laid out the lending record first: Sea at Commons, Moon at Reed Creek, Train at Farm Quay, and Phone at Mill Pond. Each flag needed a real completed loan behind it.

“Four flags,” Nib declared proudly. “Four readers with their books,” Lark added with satisfaction.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **phone**

“We can use the spellings we have already met,” Lark reminded you warmly. “Read boat and book, listening to their different vowels. Read train and phone with their prepared letter teams. Then check what each title means in our actual lending record.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try boat, book, train, phone. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Match the four slips to the four destination pictures,” Lark invited gently. “Which title is written on each current loan?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The boat has a book. The team can read it.**

“What can the team read?” Lark asked gently. “Which word does it refer back to?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The slips matched the four stops. Nib raised four flags. Visitors joined a shared shore reading while the lent books remained with their borrowers. A brass boat badge joined the collection. Lark bound your twenty chapters into The Storyboat, a record of the lending service you had helped make usable.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write boat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The fourth book joined the library. After the boat round was fully finished, a garden keeper brought a separate request for an illustrated maintenance guide. The flags marked completed loans, not promises of jobs still left undone.

Sunset at the Wrong Time

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 1

The garden keeper opened the illustrated maintenance guide beside a chime that rang at the wrong point in the garden's cycle. Nib listened carefully and proposed a larger bell. Lark watched the moving wheel instead. A louder wrong-time chime would still ring at the wrong time.

“A louder noon,” Nib suggested hopefully. “A better explanation,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **boat**

“A longer word can contain two familiar closed chunks,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read sun, then set. Join sun-set into sunset, then think about the whole meaning. Breaking a word helps us read it; joining it again helps us understand it.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sunset. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read sunset on the guide's cycle picture,” Lark invited gently. “Does that picture match the moment when we heard the chime?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The sun is up. The bell did not ring at sunset.**

“Does the passage say the bell rang at sunset?” Lark asked gently. “Which word changes that claim?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark recorded the observed mismatch without naming a cause. Nib drew the wheel mark where it had actually been, not where he expected it. The keeper agreed to another look the next morning. For today they had a useful question and an honest first note, rather than a louder bell.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write sunset beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your first garden journal page kept observation separate from explanation. Before inspecting the mechanism, the crew would need a dry, steady place to open its heavy guide.

Go to the Little Shelter

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 2

Morning showed two shelters. Nib chose the tiny roof behind a root because it looked cozy. The work table would not fit beneath it. Lark measured its footprint against the clear shelter beside the working path. The useful place was not the smallest or the prettiest.

“A cozy little shelter,” Nib declared. “A table-sized shelter,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sunset**

“A syllable ending in a vowel can have a long vowel,” Lark modeled clearly. “Listen to me with long e, go with long o, and hi with long i. Robot begins with long ro, and unit begins with /yoo/. Baby begins with long ba; its final y says long e, unlike y in my. Read those modeled chunks and rejoin each word. These examples are useful, with exceptions still possible.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try me, go, hi, robot, baby, unit. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read go in the supplied route note,” Lark invited gently. “Which shelter leaves room for the actual table?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Go to the shelter. The baby can nap.**

“Where does the first sentence send us?” Lark asked gently. “Does the second sentence give another direction or tell what someone can do?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib carried the light kit to the clear shelter. The keeper brought the table, and the closed guide rested fully on top. The crew could work beside the path without blocking it. The smaller roof remained a perfectly pleasant place for something smaller than a work station.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write go beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the real table footprint in your journal. The guide was dry inside the chosen shelter. Its cover showed beautiful plants, but the next useful page would be the one about the working mechanism.

The Theme on the Cover

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 3

Nib admired the planting pictures on the guide's cover. He opened a page of flowers while the wheel waited outside. Lark checked the operating-section tab. The picture was interesting, but it did not describe the mechanism whose timing needed investigation.

“These are splendid flowers,” Nib exclaimed. “This is the wheel’s section,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

me

“We can reuse silent-e chunks in a longer word like inside,” Lark explained clearly. “Theme and these add a rarer e-and-final-e spelling for long e. Listen to those whole examples before reading them. We don't ask their familiar-looking letters to teach an unmodeled pattern by themselves.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try inside, theme, these. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read these on the prepared tab strip,” Lark invited gently. “Then follow the supplied operating-section heading to the wheel diagram.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **These notes tell the theme. The theme is the wheel.**

“What topic do the notes concern?” Lark asked gently. “Look at the sentence with theme.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The correct section opened to a drawing of the shaded inlet. The keeper pointed out the access route and asked the crew to inspect it at the next visit. Nib slipped a marker into that page. The flowers remained in the guide for another purpose; their beauty had not made them an explanation of the fault.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write theme beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded which section mattered and why. The heavy guide stayed closed in the dry shelter overnight. Next morning, a lamp would help the crew see the inlet without changing it.

A Light for the Night Note

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 4

A deep shadow crossed the inlet. Nib called it a very solid blockage. Lark stood where the guide showed the channel, but the dark patch hid its surface. Before deciding what stopped the water, they needed a better view of what was actually there.

“A very solid shadow,” Nib whispered suspiciously. “A shadow we can look behind,” Lark replied calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **inside**

“Igh writes long i in light and night,” Lark modeled clearly. “Keep the three-letter team together. Moonlight joins moon and light into one compound. Read the parts, rejoin them, and check that the whole word fits what it describes.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try night, light, moonlight. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read light on the inspection card,” Lark invited gently. “Where can the supported lamp illuminate the inlet without moving its water or cover?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The light is on. I can see the inlet.**

“What does the light help the speaker see?” Lark asked gently. “Does the passage say the light repairs anything?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib set the lamp on a broad dry ledge. Light reached behind the shadow. Some water passed through, but less than the guide's ordinary-flow picture showed. The shadow had been a viewing problem, not proof of a blockage. The crew kept the low-flow observation and prepared to inspect the bank more closely.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write light beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the new observation beneath the first question. The lamp stayed on its real ledge. A keeper's older work record identified the corner where the inlet access cover could be reached.

The Farmer's Corner

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 5

Two corners looked alike from the shelter. Nib inspected both and reported that each was thoroughly corner-shaped. Lark brought the keeper's old work record. Its description placed the access cover beside the inlet, rather than beside the planting bed on the opposite side.

“Every corner has a corner,” Nib observed. “This record names one,” Lark replied with patient amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **night**

“Longer words can hold familiar r-controlled chunks,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read farm-er and cor-ner, then join farmer and corner smoothly. Shelter has familiar parts too. A name or heading with an untaught spelling can still be supplied without replacing our decoding.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try farmer, corner, shelter. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read corner on the prepared record,” Lark invited gently. “Which location matches the inlet in the diagram?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The farmer is by the corner. The shelter is dry.**

“Where is the farmer?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us about the shelter instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib followed the fixed path to the correct corner. Beneath a layer of loose leaves, the old access cover was visible and reachable. They left it closed while checking the next inspection step. Back in the shelter, the table rocked when the heavy guide opened. That support needed fixing before they worked from its pages.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write corner beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the access corner in your journal. It was found without moving every cover in the garden. The crew returned to the table's loose foot before bringing more heavy pages to its top.

The Table with the Little Ending

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 6

The heavy guide tipped one corner of the work table. Nib held up a tall bottle as a possible support. Lark pointed to the table's own loose foot fitting. Adding a fragile tower would leave the actual fault untouched.

“A bottle would add height,” Nib argued hopefully. “The foot would add steadiness,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **farmer**

“At the end of table, consonant-le makes an unstressed chunk,” Lark modeled clearly. “Listen to table, candle, and bottle. Join the chunks into their ordinary spoken words rather than reciting separate letter names or making every vowel equally strong.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try table, candle, bottle. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read table on the support note,” Lark invited gently. “Which fitting belongs to its own foot?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The bottle is on the table. A candle is by it.**

“Where is the bottle?” Lark asked gently. “Which object does it refer to in the other sentence?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The keeper supported the table while Nib tightened the foot. The guide opened without rocking. The bottle stayed on a shelf, where it did not have to hold a work station upright. Now the crew could compare the water-bed drawing and its actual low measuring notch.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write table beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed a table supported by its own foot. Beyond the shelter, a tall marker stood beside the low water-line notch, giving the next reading two very different heights to consider.

The Tall Marker

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 7

Nib recorded the top of the tall marker as the water level. It made the channel seem impressively full. Lark crouched beside the real water-line notch near its base. The label described a tall post; it did not say the water reached its top.

“A remarkably tall amount of water,” Nib announced. “A remarkably tall post,” Lark corrected kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **table**

“In all, tall, and ball, a has the vowel sound we are explicitly modeling here,” Lark explained clearly. “It isn't the short a of mat. Read the examples, then keep the word's meaning separate from the measurement we take beside the object.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try all, tall, ball. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tall on the comparison card,” Lark invited gently. “Which actual notch shows where the water reaches?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The post is tall. The notch is low.**

“Does tall describe the post or the notch?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes the notch?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib lowered his pencil to the observed water line. The reading was low, matching the earlier view of weak flow at the inlet. Lark crossed out the mistaken post-top measurement with a single line so the revision stayed visible. The access cover already found at the inlet was their next inspection point.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write tall beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal distinguished the marker's height from the water's level. The crew had a stronger question about the inlet, without pretending that one low reading already named its cause.

The Bank Beneath the Leaves

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 8

The keeper opened the inlet cover. Leaves lay pressed against a displaced screen. Nib fetched a brush large enough for the whole bank. Lark laid the guide beside the small screen and its collecting tray. The trouble occupied much less space than Nib's proposed sweeping route.

“The whole bank needs a brush,” Nib proposed. “This small screen needs room,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **all**

“In bank and sink, nk represents /ng/ followed closely by /k/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare ring, with its single ng sound, and bank, with the added ending. Read bank, sink, and pink without inserting a vowel inside that final group.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try bank, sink, pink. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read bank on the access note,” Lark invited gently. “Which small part does its diagram actually ask the keeper to clear?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The bank is wet. A leaf is on the screen.**

“Where is the leaf?” Lark asked gently. “Does the first sentence explain the clock timing?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The keeper lifted the leaf mat into a collecting tray and reseated the screen. Nib carried the tray away from the channel. Flow visibly improved. Then the clock chimed at the wrong point again. Lark kept both results: the inlet repair helped water flow, and the timing problem still needed explaining.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write bank beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal marked the screen repair complete without marking the whole garden fixed. The keeper's work log held earlier completed tasks and a different page for what still needed checking.

What the Keeper Planted

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 9

Nib read the work log and prepared to clear the screen again. Lark showed him the check beside the completed job. Yesterday's work and tomorrow's questions were on different pages. Repeating everything would hide the useful fact that the inlet repair was already done.

“We could plant it all again,” Nib offered eagerly. “We can read what was already done,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **bank**

“Ed can sound /t/, /d/, or /id/ in these examples,” Lark modeled clearly. “Listen to jumped, played, and planted. The same ending spelling marks completed actions, but its spoken sound changes. We'll read each whole word and connect it to what happened.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try jumped, played, planted. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the completed-task entry,” Lark invited gently. “Which work should stay checked while we inspect the remaining linkage?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam planted. Pat played by the bank.**

“Who completed the planting?” Lark asked gently. “Which action belongs to Pat instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib left the repaired screen alone. Lark added the improved-flow observation to its finished entry, then opened the current linkage note. Outside, the water wheel turned while the chime arm waited in its catch. That difference was the new question, not a reason to undo the old repair.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write planted beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept completed work and remaining questions on separate lines. The wheel's motion could now be compared directly with the waiting arm, with no new leaves introduced to explain away the mismatch.

The Wheel Still Turning

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 10

Water turned the wheel. The chime arm rested in a catch. Nib watched both, then carefully reported that one moving part was moving while another was not. Lark welcomed the smaller, clearer observation. The mechanism could be understood one relationship at a time.

“It is all turning, except the bit that is not,” Nib reported carefully. “That difference matters,” Lark replied.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **jumped**

“Ing can describe an ongoing action in planting, jumping, and resting,” Lark modeled clearly. “Here the base stays visible before ing. Compare planted with planting. Later words may need spelling changes; today we use examples whose base stays intact.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try planting, jumping, resting. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the ongoing and completed descriptions,” Lark invited gently. “Which one matches the wheel now, and which matches yesterday's screen work?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The wheel is turning. The arm is resting.**

“Which part is resting?” Lark asked gently. “Does the passage say every part has stopped?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The comparison separated current motion from finished repair. Lark followed the guide's linkage line from the waiting arm to a small reset lever. The arm was being held, not waiting for the water to begin. They left the flowing channel alone and prepared to inspect that helper control with the keeper.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write resting beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed two simultaneous states. Nib traced the linkage on paper rather than poking at the mechanism. The next test would use the lever that actually did the reset job.

The Helper Lever

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 11

Two levers had similar handles. Nib reached for the bigger one, which looked impressively helpful. The guide's small connecting line led to the other lever. Lark kept the mechanism unloaded while the keeper showed where that smaller control met the reset linkage.

“The biggest helper,” Nib announced. “The helper with this job,” Lark reminded him gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **planting**

“Er can name someone or something that does a job,” Lark explained clearly. “Help plus er makes helper; sing plus er makes singer. Read the parts, rejoin them, then ask what job the whole word describes in this sentence.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try helper, singer, player. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read helper in the prepared diagram,” Lark invited gently. “Which actual lever has the reset job?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The helper can lift the arm. The player can sing.**

“Which subject can lift the arm?” Lark asked gently. “Read the job described in each sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

With the keeper, Nib tested the small lever's unloaded movement. The linkage responded where the diagram predicted. They did not reset the live cycle yet: the guide asked for a water-and-light check first. The correct control was found, and its proper moment still needed observing.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write helper beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal connected the small lever to its actual work. Bigger handles no longer looked like better evidence. Outside, sunlight on the gauge and dampness on the guide created two practical problems for the next reading.

Sunlight and Raincoats

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 12

Sunlight flashed across the fixed gauge. A passing shower had dampened the guide's cover. Nib proposed moving the gauge, the shelter, and possibly the garden. Lark brought a small shade and a protective cover instead. They needed a clear reading from the same measuring point.

“A raincoat for a book,” Nib exclaimed delightedly. “And shade for a reading,” Lark added.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **helper**

“Join familiar words into sunlight, raincoat, and bookshop,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read each part, then check the whole meaning. A compound isn't just two sounds stuck together; its meaning helps us choose the useful item for our actual job.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sunlight, raincoat, bookshop. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read sunlight on the checking note,” Lark invited gently. “How can we shade the gauge while leaving its measuring point fixed?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The sunlight is on the shelf. The raincoat is on the hook.**

“Which thing is on the hook?” Lark asked gently. “Where does the sunlight fall?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib shaded the gauge without moving it. Lark protected the guide and opened the correct page. The reading could now be repeated from the same place. A faint instruction described a waiting interval before the reset, but its word about sounded odd when every vowel was spoken with equal force.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write sunlight beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the fixed measuring point in its picture. A better view had changed the readability, not the evidence. The waiting instruction was the next piece of text to understand.

A Little Word Goes Quiet

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 13

Nib sounded every vowel in about as strongly as he could. The result seemed so odd that he suspected the note. Lark spoke the sentence naturally, then returned to the same printed word. Nothing had vanished from the paper; one unstressed vowel was simply quieter in speech.

“A very sleepy vowel,” Nib whispered suspiciously. “A quiet one in this word,” Lark explained gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sunlight**

“In about, the first vowel is weak, /uh/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Lemon and seven have weak vowels in their unstressed parts too. We'll explicitly hear and rejoin these words. Flexible pronunciation helps us recognize a decoded word; it doesn't mean replacing it with a picture guess.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try about, lemon, seven. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Rejoin about, then reread its supplied sentence,” Lark invited gently. “What does the note ask us to observe before the reset?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The note is about the lever. I can see seven marks.**

“What is the note about?” Lark asked gently. “Does the second sentence tell us its topic or count something?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The note called for a brief observing pause before the wheel reached its marked point. Nib waited beside the keeper and watched the mark instead of tugging at the lever. The complete sequence now made sense: check flow, watch the cycle, then use the small control at the shown position.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write about beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the instruction in the right order. The keeper had the actual lever ready. The next test could now check timing without confusing a hard-to-read word with a faulty mechanism.

The Reset at Last

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 14

The keeper showed the linkage's old position beside the newly observed cycle mark. Water flowed through the cleared screen. The gauge remained fixed. Nib watched the wheel's mark approach instead of judging the moment by how long he had been waiting.

“The right helper at the right moment,” Nib murmured proudly. “And the water still flowing,” Lark added.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **about**

“Use the longer-word strategies we already know,” Lark invited warmly. “Read shelter by its chunks and sunbeam by its joined words. Check the complete operating sentence after joining each word. Today we apply prepared reading rather than introduce a surprise new spelling.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try shelter, sunbeam, cupcake. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the supplied check sequence,” Lark invited gently. “Which observed position comes before the keeper moves the reset lever?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Look at the wheel mark. Then lift the small lever.**

“What must we look at before lifting the lever?” Lark asked gently. “Use the order in the passage.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

At the shown mark, the keeper moved the small control. On the next cycle, the arm released at the intended point. The water kept flowing. They watched another pass before recording that timing and flow now agreed in the test. A fresh visitor note would still check whether the instructions made sense to a new reader.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write shelter beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the test result beside the earlier observations. Nib left the larger bell where it had always been. The mechanism worked in its test; the next question concerned a reader using a new page.

A Page Nobody Practiced

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 15

The keeper brought a new little visitor page about a hut and a lamp. Its scene was different from the mechanism the crew had discussed all week. Nib looked uncertain because nobody had practiced this exact passage aloud. Lark left its answer covered while you began.

“A page we have not practiced,” Nib whispered anxiously. “We can try it, and ask when we need to,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **shelter**

“We can use familiar spellings on an unfamiliar page,” Lark explained warmly. “Read the words, then think about what the sentences tell us. Asking for help with a word is allowed. It doesn't change the garden's opening into a prize for reading unaided.”

“Try the fresh passage before we look at its scene,” Lark invited gently. “Where does it put the lamp?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The lamp is in the hut. The path is by the hut.**

“Is the lamp on the path or inside the hut?” Lark asked gently. “Find the sentence that tells us.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The scene materials waited on a separate dry board. After your reading, Lark opened the picture space so the lamp could be placed according to the text. If help was needed, the same words remained available. The crew used the experience to make the visitor note clearer, without inventing a reading result for anyone.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write lamp beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the actual visitor-page task. The mechanism did not have to be repaired again. With a usable note and a checked cycle, the garden was ready for its real reopening.

The Garden Opens

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 16

Neighbors came over several story days as the garden settled into its restored routine. Seeds remained seeds until they had time to grow. The keeper opened the gate to the visitor path. Nib listened to the chime, pleased that it marked the right part of an ordinary cycle.

“Not a larger bell after all,” Nib observed happily. “A garden we understand,” Lark replied with satisfaction.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **lamp**

“Read the useful words in our visitor note,” Lark invited warmly. “Join garden, helper, and planted from their prepared parts. Then keep three checks separate: water passing, timing matching, and visitors having a clear way in.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try garden, helper, planted. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Use the note and our three pictures,” Lark invited gently. “Which one shows water, which shows timing, and which shows access?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The helper planted in the garden. The path is dry.**

“What is dry for the visitors?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us about earlier planting instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The keeper ran a full demonstrated cycle. Flow passed the reseated screen, the reset arm released at its marked point, and visitors used the clear path. Lark retold the two faults without calling either one a spell. The leaf stamp joined your collection, and sixteen journal chapters became The Clockwork Garden.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write helper beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The fifth book joined the library. Visitors admired the clear signs and asked about making more. An unused workshop offered a possible later project. Today, the garden's water, timing, and access were all working.

Unpack the Almost Machine

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 1

The garden was open, and neighbors wanted a story-making station they could share at different places. Inside an unused workshop, Nib unrolled a magnificent plan wider than the door. Lark measured the actual opening. Beside it she drew four requirements: portable, dry, readable, and usable together. The door would keep its present size.

“An unfinished masterpiece,” Nib proclaimed proudly. “One useful beginning,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **garden**

“In unpack and unlock, un changes the action,” Lark modeled clearly. “Pack puts things together for carrying; unpack reverses that. Lock secures something; unlock reverses that. Read the visible base, add un, and check the new whole meaning.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try unpack, unlock. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read unpack on the storage note,” Lark invited gently. “Which small existing press can we lay out for one useful design?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can unlock the box. We can unpack the press.**

“What do the helpers unpack?” Lark asked gently. “Which action happens to the box first?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib unlocked the correct storage latch. A small hand press and its needed frame parts came onto the supported bench. The enormous drawing remained a drawing. Lark kept the door measurement and four requirements beside the smaller model. Its feed tray faced the wall, giving the next revision a clear purpose.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write unpack beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your first workshop journal page showed the real press, the unchanged door, and four visible jobs the finished station must do. Nib had found a useful beginning among many almost-finished ideas.

Redo the First Try

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 2

The feed tray pointed neatly into the wall. Nib studied the wall as if a new doorway might solve everything. Lark touched the tray's actual bracket. The workshop could stay where it was. One unloaded part needed fitting again in a better direction.

“A new workshop would solve it,” Nib suggested hopefully. “Refitting one tray might be quicker,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **unpack**

“Re can mean again in these words,” Lark modeled clearly. “Pack again becomes repack. Fit again becomes refit. Do again becomes redo. Read the base and the added part, then name the small action we actually need to repeat.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try repack, refit, redo. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read refit on the revision note,” Lark invited warmly. “Which way should the tray face to leave working space?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can refit the tray. We can repack the box.**

“Which thing is fitted again?” Lark asked gently. “Which action happens to the box instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib released the unloaded tray while Lark supported its weight. It turned on its own bracket and fitted toward the clear bench area. The revision worked without a new workshop. Now the tray could be reached, but a long press handle swept through the place where a second helper needed to stand.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write refit beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the revised tray on your journal page. One observed problem had one useful correction. The next test would ask whether two helpers could use the same station together.

Helpful Handles

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 3

Nib pulled the long handle through a grand sweeping arc. Lark stepped back because it crossed her whole working place. Nib could operate the press, but nobody could help him feed the paper. The four requirement pictures remained beside the model, including the one showing two helpers.

“A handful of handle,” Nib declared grandly. “A helpful handle,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **repack**

“Help plus ful becomes helpful,” Lark explained clearly. “The ending is weak in ordinary speech, not a separate strongly spoken full. Hopeful works the same way. Read the parts, rejoin the word, and ask whether the object really helps the intended job.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try helpful, hopeful. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read helpful on our test card,” Lark invited gently. “Which handle leaves the second helper's footprint clear?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The short handle is helpful. I am hopeful.**

“What does the first sentence call helpful?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes a feeling?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib fitted a shorter supported handle. Lark stood in the marked second place while he tested its travel. Neither helper had to jump away. The handle still reached its stop and worked the press. The cooperative requirement had a real test behind it, even though the paper feed still needed attention.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write helpful beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed both working places. Nib liked the shorter handle's useful reach. Next, a sheet of paper needed to arrive flat instead of racing past the printing position.

Slowly Through the Rollers

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 4

Nib pulled the paper with a flourish. A corner folded beneath the roller, and the printing space stayed empty. Lark loosened the unloaded feed before the crease grew deeper. The alignment marks were still visible on both sides of the sheet.

“A very swift page,” Nib exclaimed. “A flat page would be useful,” Lark replied with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **helpful**

“Ly changes how an action is described in slowly and softly,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read slow plus ly, then soft plus ly. The feed note uses those words for an actual job: moving the paper flat. It isn't asking for a race or a timed performance.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try softly, slowly. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read slowly on the feed note,” Lark invited gently. “Which alignment marks keep the sheet flat as it moves?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Feed the sheet slowly. Set it softly on the mat.**

“How should the sheet move?” Lark asked gently. “Find the describing word in the first sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib held the roller steady while Lark guided the sheet along the visible marks. At a comfortable pace, it reached the print position without a trapped corner. The paper could now arrive where it belonged. Behind it, the rest of the roll stretched across the bench with no clear page ending.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write slowly beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept a flat-sheet drawing beside the alignment marks. The feed worked without measuring anyone's reaction time. The next question was how much paper would make a page somebody could carry.

The Endless Page

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 5

Nib unrolled a magnificent paper path across the workshop. Nobody could lift it without standing on its middle. It was certainly long enough for an impressive story, but not a page for the garden's little reading rest. Lark held the rest's actual outline beside the roll.

“An endless story,” Nib announced proudly. “A page someone can hold,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **softly**

“End plus less makes endless: without an end,” Lark modeled clearly. “Hope plus less makes hopeless, a different meaning from hopeful. Listen to the ordinary weak ending, read the parts, and check how less changes the whole word.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try endless, hopeless. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read endless on our comparison card,” Lark invited gently. “Which marked length fits the reading rest rather than the whole workshop?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The page is endless. The sheet can fit the rest.**

“Which piece can fit the reading rest?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us why a sheet is useful?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib marked a page boundary against the real outline. The workshop keeper separated the sheet at that mark while everyone else stood clear. The cut page could be lifted and carried without dragging a trail. The remaining roll stayed on its holder for later pages, instead of disappearing after one print.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write endless beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew a real page with four edges in your journal. The station could feed it and a reader could hold it. Now sheets and tools needed labeled storage that made retrieval possible.

Boxes for the Right Things

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 6

The workshop had several bins, but every label named only one object. Nib put everything that looked numerous into the biggest box. When Lark asked for a clean sheet, a handle arrived first. The station needed labels matched to contents rather than container size.

“A box for boxes,” Nib proposed enthusiastically. “A label for the things inside,” Lark replied kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **endless**

“Plural endings can have different sounds,” Lark modeled clearly. “Cats ends with /s/, bins with /z/, and boxes with an extra /iz/ syllable. Read the base and ending, then connect the word to more than one of the things it names.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cats, bins, boxes. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the storage labels,” Lark invited gently. “Which one belongs to the clean sheets, and which names the tools?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The cats sit by the bins. I can shut the boxes.**

“What can the speaker shut?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence names the cats?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib sorted the supplies into their intended bins. Lark attached the corrected labels, and they tried a real retrieval. A sheet came from the paper place, and a tool came from its own box. Beside them, a painted cover had finished drying over several story days. An older note still described it as waiting.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write boxes beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the working storage layout. The next helper could find paper without opening every box. The finished cover needed its old progress note brought up to date.

Painted, Not Waiting

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 7

The cover was dry. The earlier note still said it was waiting. Nib proposed repainting it to make the scene match the old note. Lark showed the completed-work record instead. A record should follow the actual work, rather than make finished work happen again.

“It has been waiting for its note to catch up,” Nib observed. “We can help the note,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cats**

“We already met the different ed sounds,” Lark reminded you warmly. “When hope already ends in e, add d for hoped. Bake becomes baked the same way. Painted keeps its extra ending syllable. Read the visible base and the actual change before rejoining each word.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try hoped, baked, painted. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the completed-work note,” Lark invited gently. “Does the dry cover need new paint, or does its old label need updating?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam baked. Pat painted the box.**

“Who painted the box?” Lark asked gently. “What completed action belongs to Sam?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib checked the real surface with the keeper. Lark updated the note to painted and dry, leaving its earlier date visible. The cover fitted over the station without a new coat of paint. Underneath, the moving feed belt had a loose side guide that needed checking next.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write painted beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the finished cover on the machine. A more accurate note had saved a needless job. The feed belt could be tested once its loose edge was properly guided.

Running Without Getting Away

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 8

The belt moved around its rollers, but one loose side began slipping outward. Nib called it running away. Lark stopped the unloaded mechanism. The belt stayed attached while they studied the side-guide diagram beside the actual roller.

“Running, but not leaving,” Nib declared with relief. “Exactly its job,” Lark agreed.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **hoped**

“For these short-vowel bases, double the final consonant before ing,” Lark modeled clearly. “Run becomes running; tap becomes tapping; hop becomes hopping. The doubled letter preserves the spelling pattern. It doesn't add a second consonant sound when we speak the word.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try running, tapping, hopping. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read running on the belt note,” Lark invited gently. “Which guide keeps the moving belt on its own rollers?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The belt is running. Sam is tapping the box.**

“What is running?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes Sam's different action?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib seated the side guide while Lark held the belt level. One slow test movement carried it around the rollers without slipping. They checked its return to the starting point before leaving it fitted. Nib wrote a cheerful note about hoping the next test would work, and its spelling suggested another useful comparison.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write running beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept running beside the securely guided belt. No hopping was needed beside the mechanism. Nib's next note would need to distinguish that action from the rather different idea of hoping.

Hoping Is Not Hopping

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 9

Lark read Nib's note as hopping and began to demonstrate, then caught herself beside the carefully aligned press. Nib pointed to the long-vowel base he had intended. He wanted to describe hoping for success, not bouncing near the rollers.

“I was hoping, not hopping,” Nib protested earnestly. “A useful difference,” Lark replied with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **running**

“Compare hop and hope,” Lark modeled clearly. “Hop doubles p for hopping. Hope drops its final e before ing to make hoping, while the long vowel remains. Make becomes making in the same way. Read the bases before comparing the changed words.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try hoping, making. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read hoping and hopping,” Lark invited gently. “Which word matches Nib's intended meaning without asking anyone to jump?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I am hoping. Sam is making a box.**

“Who is making something?” Lark asked gently. “Does the first sentence say the speaker is hopping?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib corrected the progress note. Lark reread the whole sentence and understood his meaning. The press stayed still throughout the word comparison. Now the fitted tray, short handle, feed, page supply, and cover could become one portable station rather than separate successes scattered across a bench.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write hoping beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the two spellings with their different meanings. The message was clear. The next test returned to the unchanged door and the original requirement that the station must travel.

One Story-Making Station

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 10

The bench version worked. It was still too wide for the door. Nib considered calling it a splendid indoor invention forever. Lark held the original measuring strip beside the opening. Portable had been one of the four promises from the first day.

“Almost portable,” Nib sighed. “One useful fold closer,” Lark replied encouragingly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **hoping**

“Familiar compounds help us keep the whole purpose in view,” Lark explained warmly. “Read storybook, sunlight, and raincoat by their prepared parts. Then read the requirement pictures together: our story-making station must travel, stay dry, print readably, and let helpers work together.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try storybook, sunlight, raincoat. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Compare the folding-frame plan with the original measure,” Lark invited gently. “Which arrangement fits the same door while keeping the parts attached?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The storybook is dry. The raincoat is on the hook.**

“Which object is dry?” Lark asked gently. “Which one hangs on the hook?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib folded the frame at its real pivots. Lark checked the attached handle and tray against the measuring strip. The folded station fitted the opening without a changed doorway. They unfolded it on the workshop floor and checked that the working places returned to position. A real authored message was the remaining thing to prepare.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write storybook beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the same station folded and working. The four requirements stayed beside it. Now a blank source sheet waited for something an actual reader would want to know.

A Sentence for Someone

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 11

Nib arranged a long row of impressive labels on the blank page. Lark read them and still did not know what the page wanted its reader to do. She moved the labels aside, leaving space for one meaningful sentence chosen by the person making it.

“A sentence with a job,” Nib murmured thoughtfully. “And a reader,” Lark added warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **storybook**

“A sentence tells someone something,” Lark explained warmly. “We begin with a prepared capital, leave spaces between words, and end a statement with a full stop. I can unpack the box is one example, not a message you have to choose. We'll reread your actual words for meaning.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try I, can, unpack, the, box. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Choose, arrange, type, or dictate a message for a real reader,” Lark invited gently. “What should your page tell that person?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can unpack the box. The sheet is on the tray.**

“What can the speaker do?” Lark asked gently. “How is that different from telling us where the sheet is?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The source strip stayed blank until your chosen words were ready. Lark could supply any unprepared spelling and read it back with you. Nib set a clean sheet beside the ink tray and source-plate holder. The station would print the real message rather than award a prewritten sentence as a prize.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write your chosen sentence beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the actual message source with its spaces and full stop. The example stayed available for support. The next outing would test the station at the garden reading place with your own source, paper, and ink.

Almost Becomes Ready

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 6, Episode 12

The folded station rolled through the same workshop door. Nib carried its packed supplies to the garden reading place. Lark checked the attached parts when they unfolded the frame. The four requirement pictures came too: portable, dry, readable, and usable together.

“A finished almost-machine,” Nib exclaimed joyfully. “A useful ready-machine,” Lark replied with satisfaction.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **I**

“Let's reread the message you actually chose,” Lark invited warmly. “We can help with any word. Then we'll check the four original requirements against what the station does here, rather than how splendid it looked in the first drawing.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try unpack, helpful, making. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Use the prepared source and clean sheet,” Lark invited gently. “Which job will each helper take so the page reaches its reader?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I am making a page. The helpful team can read it.**

“What is the speaker making?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us who can read it?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib set the visible source plate, paper, and ink in their prepared places. Lark helped operate the press while the source was checked against the new page. Any unclear mark could be revised. The station used real supplies to make a readable copy; it did not duplicate books by magic. The workshop stamp joined your collection.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write a word from your own message beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark bound The Workshop of Almost. The shared plans and working press remained available for more pages. Only after that project was finished did Nib notice how quiet the familiar brook sounded beside the garden. Tomorrow's question could wait beside today's finished invention.

The Morning the Brook Went Quiet

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 1

The story press worked, and the garden remained open. On the familiar path, Nib stopped to listen. The brook sounded unusually quiet, and less water showed between its usual stones. Lark brought the field notebook, the ordinary viewing lens, and a borrowed channel diagram. The moonstone stayed at camp; this question needed observations.

“A brook having a nap?” Nib wondered softly. “A brook we should look at carefully,” Lark replied.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **unpack**

“A useful observation note gives a place, a time, and what we actually notice,” Lark explained gently. “I can supply the word quiet; it isn't an independent spelling task today. Read note and brook, then keep what we see separate from our ideas about why.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try note, brook. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Which picture records the change beside this same path?” Lark invited gently. “What can we record before choosing an explanation?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The brook is low. I can see the bank.**

“What does the passage report about the brook?” Lark asked gently. “Does it tell us why?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark dated the notebook's new observation. Nib drew the same stones with the lower visible water, leaving space below for questions. A brook taking a nap was an amusing idea, not a measured cause. The diagram offered a way to inspect the upstream route without deciding the answer in advance.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write note beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your first investigation page kept the question open. The crew packed the notebook and followed the dry path toward the fixed bridge, ready to use the diagram's arrows.

The Arrow Under the Bridge

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 2

Nib turned the channel diagram until its prettiest tree matched a nearby trunk. The bridge in the drawing then pointed in an impossible direction. Lark set the page against the real fixed bridge instead. Inlet, gate, alternate route, and outlet could now keep the same relationship on paper and ground.

“The arrow is wandering,” Nib complained mildly. “Our page is turning,” Lark observed gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **note**

“A diagram's arrows tell us relationships and direction,” Lark explained clearly. “Read in-let and out-let as joined familiar parts. We'll orient the page to the fixed bridge before following an arrow, then check that its endpoint matches the place we reach.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try inlet, outlet, chart. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read inlet and outlet on the chart,” Lark invited gently. “Which arrow gives the first upstream inspection?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The inlet is at the top. The outlet is at the end.**

“Which label belongs at the end in this little diagram description?” Lark asked gently. “Use the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib walked along the dry route beside the inlet arrow. Lark checked its endpoint against the real access place. They reached the intended inspection point without entering the water or turning a control. A keeper's crowded page waited in the notebook pocket, describing what had last been noticed here.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write inlet beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the oriented chart. The bridge stayed the fixed reference. Now the crew had to find the useful water observations among the keeper page's many other details.

The Busy Page

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 3

The keeper's page mentioned weather, a picnic, and observations from two water points. Nib chose the picnic as the most promising detail. Lark enjoyed its sandwich drawing, then placed the quiet-brook question beside the page. The most interesting sentence was not necessarily the one that helped answer it.

“The picnic is an excellent detail,” Nib insisted. “An excellent detail for another question,” Lark replied kindly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **inlet**

“A main idea must fit the useful details,” Lark explained gently. “First ask what question we are trying to answer. Then read for the sentences that bear on it. We can enjoy the picnic without treating it as evidence about the water route.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try inlet, outlet, branch. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the short page, then find its two water observations,” Lark invited gently. “Which detail belongs to another topic?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The inlet is wet. The outlet is dry. A cake is on the mat.**

“Which two sentences help with the water question?” Lark asked gently. “Which one tells us something else?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The page placed water at one recorded point and none at the other. Lark underlined those sentences after the reading. They narrowed the question to the route between the points. Neither sentence yet showed what had changed that route. Nib left the picnic drawing in its margin, interesting and properly separate.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write inlet beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal gained a smaller question, supported by the right details. The crew would need an observation that could distinguish a dry supply from water taking a different path.

A Because That Needed Proof

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 4

Lark wondered whether the supply had dried. Nib wondered whether the gate sent water somewhere else. Both ideas could explain a quieter brook from a distance. Neither was proved by sounding sensible. The channel diagram showed where their predictions would differ.

“A convincing because,” Nib announced. “A because we can check,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **inlet**

“An if statement makes a prediction we can check,” Lark explained clearly. “If no water reaches the inlet, a direct inlet look should show that. If water is arriving but taking another route, the observation should differ. Our preferred story must wait for the check.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try if, gap, branch. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Which observation would help separate the two ideas?” Lark invited gently. “Use the diagram to choose a place where their predictions differ.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **If the inlet is dry, the brook can be dry. If the inlet is wet, look at the gate.**

“What check follows a wet inlet in this plan?” Lark asked gently. “Is an if sentence a result we already observed?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The crew planned a direct inlet and gate inspection from the fixed dry platform. Lark wrote the predictions on separate lines. Nib packed the notebook instead of a repair tool. Before changing anything, they would read how to approach and record the scene without destroying the evidence they came to inspect.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write if beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal now held possibilities and a useful next check. The route was chosen for information, not because either friend's first explanation had won a vote.

Look Before the Lever

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 5

At the approach, Nib reached toward a handle. Lark opened the how-to page. Its first picture showed a person looking from the dry platform with a notebook. The handle belonged to a later step. Moving it now would change the very arrangement they wanted to understand.

“A lever with possibilities,” Nib whispered eagerly. “A look before a lever,” Lark reminded him gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **if**

“Read the instructions in order, keeping their goal in view,” Lark explained gently. “Look and record come before change. First and then help us connect the steps. We can leave the page open beside its matching pictures rather than remember every word at once.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try look, first, then. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the first two directions,” Lark invited gently. “Which action belongs before touching a control?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **First look at the gate. Then make a note.**

“What comes before making the note?” Lark asked gently. “Does either sentence ask us to move the gate?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib put his paw back beside the notebook. They followed the dry approach and stopped at the fixed viewing position. The gate was visible, but a loose old label made the alternate channel hard to identify. They recorded that uncertainty instead of moving the gate to see what happened.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write first beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the untouched scene. The next job was matching labels to their real anchors, so the crew could describe the channels accurately before testing an explanation.

The Label on the Wrong Side

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 6

A loose label lay beside the wrong channel. Nib trusted its landing place until Lark noticed its old mounting holes. On the diagram, the label's anchor belonged to a supported post beside the alternate route. The water control had not moved just because its sign had fallen.

“The label was here,” Nib argued uncertainly. “Its post was over there,” Lark replied carefully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

look

“A label needs its correct connection,” Lark explained clearly. “Read the word, follow its diagram anchor, and compare the actual mounting holes. Moving a loose sign back to its post can repair our description without changing the water arrangement we are investigating.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try gate, gap, pool. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Match the alternate-channel label to its original post,” Lark invited gently. “Which anchor agrees with both the chart and the real holes?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The pool is past the gate. The gap is by the bank.**

“What lies past the gate in the short description?” Lark asked gently. “Where does it put the gap?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib replaced the loose label on its original support. Lark checked inlet, gate, alternate channel, and usual brook against the same diagram. They could now describe the scene without trusting where a fallen sign happened to lie. The keeper's older dry-weather note could be compared with today's observation fairly.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write gate beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal gained corrected labels while the control stayed untouched. Next came two records from different mornings, each with its own time and place.

Two Notes, Two Mornings

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 7

The older note described a genuinely dry period. Today's note recorded water at the inlet. Lark's first explanation had fitted the older page, and she had nearly carried it into the present without checking its date. Nib placed both notes beside the current diagram.

“I preferred my first explanation,” Lark admitted ruefully. “The brook has supplied another detail,” Nib observed gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **gate**

“Two records can both be accurate about different moments,” Lark explained thoughtfully. “Read each source's place and time before deciding that they disagree. Then compare the current observation with the prediction we wrote for a dry supply.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try note, date, wet, dry. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Which note describes today's inlet?” Lark invited gently. “What does it make us reconsider about the dry-supply idea?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **At first, the inlet had no flow. At this check, the inlet is wet.**

“Do the sentences describe the same check?” Lark asked gently. “Which words show a change of time?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark marked her earlier explanation as a possibility no longer fitting the current inlet observation. She did not erase the old note or pretend it had been false. Nib kept today's water observation beside the revised question. With the keeper, they could now inspect the branch and gate directly from the prepared position.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write date beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal preserved the changed explanation and the evidence that changed it. Lark closed the older note carefully. The next observation would show the actual branch-gate relationship rather than merely predict one.

First the Branch, Then the Brook

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 8

From the fixed platform, the keeper showed the trapped branch. It held the old gate in the alternate-routing position. The crew could finally see that physical relationship directly. Lark recorded the before state. Nib traced the usual brook and alternate channel on the unchanged diagram.

“A branch with a very large consequence,” Nib murmured. “A consequence we have watched,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **note**

“Keep action and result on different lines,” Lark explained clearly. “The process page tells the keeper what to do. Our next observation tells us what happened afterward. A repair that sounds sensible still needs its result checked.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try branch, lift, if, then. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read and order the visible process steps,” Lark invited gently. “What happens to the branch before the supported gate is reset?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **First lift the branch. Then set the gate.**

“Which action comes first?” Lark asked gently. “Does this process passage itself tell us the later result?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The keeper removed the trapped branch and reset the gate on its supports. Nib stayed on the dry platform with the notebook. Water followed the usual channel again. Lark recorded that observed result separately from the repair action. They planned a later check rather than treating one moment of returning flow as every answer they might need.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write branch beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal now held before, action, and result. The branch-gate cause had been directly checked. A visitor could use that explanation, while questions the notes had never measured still remained open.

A Question the Page Can Answer

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 9

A visitor asked what changed and whether every animal had returned. Nib opened the notebook confidently, then stopped. It held a repair record, but no animal count. Lark set the two questions beside the page so each could be judged against the information actually there.

“A page with an answer,” Nib exclaimed. “And a question it cannot answer yet,” Lark added gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **branch**

“A useful page can answer some questions and leave others open,” Lark explained gently. “Find the sentence supporting an answer. If no observation or count was recorded, say that the page does not tell us. We can choose a new limited observation without inventing an old one.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try page, can, tell, note. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Which question can our repair page answer?” Lark invited gently. “Which one would need a different observation?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The branch held the gate. The page has no count.**

“What does the page lack?” Lark asked gently. “Which question could that missing information affect?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The notes supported the branch-and-gate explanation and the observed return of flow. They did not support a claim about every animal. Nib left that answer open. The crew planned a limited follow-up at the same brook view. A new morning note was kept closed until its first reading in the final chapter.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write page beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal became more useful because it kept its limits visible. The repair was complete. The final visit would compare a fresh note with the same familiar brook rather than pretend to count every living thing.

The Brook and the New Page

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 7, Episode 10

The new morning note lay face down beside the notebook. Nib kept its answer to himself. Lark brought the crew to the same dry viewing place used at the beginning, leaving the fresh words covered until you were ready. The older observations and repair record stayed available for comparison.

“The brook has returned to its sentence,” Nib murmured happily. “And we can say what changed,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **page**

“This is a fresh page with familiar spellings,” Lark explained warmly. “Try its words before I read them aloud. You can ask for help with any part. Then we'll compare what it says with the same place we recorded before.”

“Read the new note,” Lark invited gently. “What does it report, and what can we check by looking from here?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The gate is up. The brook is in the sun.**

“Where does the note put the brook?” Lark asked gently. “Does it tell us how many animals are here?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

After the reading, the crew compared the note with the actual gate and usual brook. Lark added the limited follow-up observation beside the before-and-after record. The ordinary field lens joined your collection. Observations, predictions, actions, and results remained distinct as the journal pages became a finished book.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write brook beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Field Notes joined the library as the seventh finished adventure. The brook mystery had a local cause, an ordinary repair, and a checked result. Beside the old atlas waited a blank route page for a later expedition the child could choose and lead.

Pick Our Path

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 8, Episode 1

Seven finished books stood in the library. The atlas lay open to a blank page beside three invitations: a sunny meadow for a picnic or flower viewing, a broad pine lookout for sketching, and a dry reed-bank platform for sharing a book. Lark made room beside her. This time the purpose and destination belonged to your choice.

“Where shall we go?” Lark asked curiously. “I shall bring the useful things,” Nib promised earnestly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **gate**

“We can read to choose something we want to do,” Lark explained warmly. “Sun has our short u, pine has long i with final e, and reed has ee. Read the three labels, then connect each one to its offered purpose. None is a better reading answer.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sun, pine, reed. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Which outing would you like to plan, and what would you like to do there?” Lark asked gently. “You can point, tell us, or use the invitation pictures.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The sun is up. The pine is tall. The reed is by the bank.**

“Which sentence connects the reed to a place?” Lark asked gently. “Which invitation fits your own purpose?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark entered the selected invitation in the destination space on the atlas draft. The other invitations stayed available for another day. Choosing a route did not claim the crew had visited it yet. Nib set out three more spaces beside it: equipment, stopping place, and a useful condition or alternative.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write your selected route label beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your first atlas journal page would keep the actual route and purpose you selected. A second source waited for each possible outing, ready to add preparation information the cheerful invitation had left out.

Another Page, One Better Plan

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 8, Episode 2

Sun route: meadow

The meadow invitation promised space to enjoy a picnic or look at flowers. Its second page showed a shade cloth and a mat. Nib brought a whole tower of workshop boxes. Lark put the equipment page beside the four planning spaces and waited to see what the outing actually required.

“The entire workshop?” Nib offered hopefully. “The things our page asks for,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sun**

“A second source can add something the first leaves out,” Lark explained gently. “Read its preparation words, then connect them to your chosen purpose. We need a reason for each item, not every item that happens to fit in a bag.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try pack, kit, shade, coat. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the meadow equipment passage,” Lark invited gently. “Which two things serve this outing?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Pack the mat. Pack the shade cloth.**

“Which two things does the page ask us to pack?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib returned the workshop boxes. The shade cloth and mat went into the kit, with their attachment pieces packed beside them. Lark left the destination in its own space and added the actual equipment to the next. The page had improved the same meadow plan rather than sending the crew on a different outing.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write mat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your meadow draft now named its useful kit. If a word or instruction still needed help, the same page would remain available before anyone had to explain the plan.

Pine route: lookout

The pine invitation offered a broad lookout for sketching. A second page pictured a light coat and sketch board. Nib brought several picnic baskets instead. Lark laid the preparation note beside the selected purpose so the equipment could serve the drawing trip.

“The entire workshop?” Nib offered hopefully. “The things our page asks for,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sun**

“A second source can supply missing preparation,” Lark explained gently. “Read the equipment words and connect them to the sketching purpose. The right kit is the one with a reason to come, rather than the largest pile we can carry.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try pack, kit, shade, coat. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the pine equipment passage,” Lark invited gently. “Which items belong to the planned sketching stop?”

Lark supplied board aloud before the passage. You could use those topic words with her help; their unprepared spellings were not words you had to decode alone.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Pack the coat. Pack the sketch board.**

“Which items does this page ask us to bring?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib packed the light coat and sketch board, leaving unrelated baskets at camp. Lark recorded that actual kit in the second planning space. The pine route stayed selected. The crew had learned more about the same outing, not completed it by packing.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write coat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your pine draft now included its useful kit. The direction page could be revisited with whatever support made it understandable before the crew summarized the plan.

Reed route: book stop

The reed invitation promised a quiet waterside book stop on a dry platform. Its second page showed a protective book cover and mat. Nib reached for the workshop's heavy tool chest. Lark held the book page beside the actual purpose of the trip.

“The entire workshop?” Nib offered hopefully. “The things our page asks for,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sun**

“A second source adds preparation to the invitation,” Lark explained gently. “Read the equipment words, then ask how each thing helps our book stop. We can supply an unfamiliar topic word without pretending it was read independently.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try pack, kit, shade, coat. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the reed equipment passage,” Lark invited gently. “What protects the book, and what gives us a place to settle?”

Lark supplied cover aloud before the passage. You could use those topic words with her help; their unprepared spellings were not words you had to decode alone.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Pack the dry cover. Pack the mat.**

“Which packed item protects the book?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib packed the dry cover and mat, with the chosen book protected inside its folio. The heavy tool chest stayed in the workshop. Lark entered the equipment in its own planning space. A waterside plan could be pleasant and still account carefully for keeping paper dry.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write cover beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your reed draft held its purpose and useful kit. The dry-cover instruction remained available if anyone wanted to hear, decode, or discuss part of it again.

Help When We Need It

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 8, Episode 3

Sun route: meadow

The meadow page stayed open beside the packed shade cloth. Lark left room to mark any actual uncertainty about its words or shade placement. Nib did not invent a hard word for you. If everything already made sense, the crew could simply keep using the page.

“A sound question or a meaning question?” Lark asked gently. “A question with a useful answer,” Nib added hopefully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **pack**

“Help can answer different needs,” Lark explained warmly. “We can hear a sound or chunk, discuss a meaning, or replay the relevant sentence. Choose what would help with your actual question, or continue without help if you don't need it.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try help, page. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Is there a part of this shade instruction you want help with?” Lark asked gently.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The shade is by the path. The mat can sit in the shade.**

“Where can the mat go?” Lark asked gently. “Which words help you decide?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Any chosen support would stay attached to the same passage. Lark could model a needed part, then invite a reread in context. The planning space would be settled when the information made sense, with whatever support had been used. Nobody had to demonstrate a difficulty to continue.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write a useful word from your page beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your meadow plan kept its shaded placement. The next job was telling the crew the information in an order they could use.

Pine route: lookout

A direction phrase on the pine page could be marked if it caused real uncertainty. Lark kept its diagram beside the sentence. Nib waited with the sketch board instead of reading the answer over your shoulder. If the direction was already clear, no help ritual was needed.

“A sound question or a meaning question?” Lark asked gently. “A question with a useful answer,” Nib added hopefully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **pack**

“Choose support for the part you actually need,” Lark offered warmly. “A sound model helps decode; a meaning explanation helps understand; a replay helps reconnect the sentence. You may also continue unaided. The point is using the page, not proving you can refuse help.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try help, page. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Would any part of the pine direction benefit from a model, explanation, or replay?” Lark asked gently.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

The pine is by the hut. The path is wide.

“What does the page say about the path?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark would use the chosen support on the actual phrase, then return to its meaning in the plan. The selected pine outing and equipment remained in view. A supported reading could guide a useful trip just as a reading without help could.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write a useful direction word beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your pine plan kept the understood direction with its source. The crew would next need that information explained in a clear order.

Reed route: book stop

The dry-cover instruction stayed beside the reed route's packed book. Lark offered space to mark any real question about it. Nib left the cover open for inspection. Nobody pretended you had struggled with a word before you had even tried it.

“A sound question or a meaning question?” Lark asked gently. “A question with a useful answer,” Nib added hopefully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **pack**

“Help should fit the question,” Lark explained warmly. “We can model a sound or chunk, explain a meaning, or replay the relevant sentence. Or we can continue without help. We'll keep the actual source visible so the support changes what you can use.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try help, page. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Is any part of the cover instruction unclear?” Lark asked gently. “Choose help only if it would be useful.”

Lark supplied cover aloud before the passage. You could use those topic words with her help; their unprepared spellings were not words you had to decode alone.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The book is in the dry cover. The mat is by the kit.**

“What keeps the book dry in this passage?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Any requested model or explanation would return to the same book-cover instruction. Lark would invite a reread and check what the instruction meant for the packed book. Whatever support was used, the purpose remained sharing the book on the dry platform.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write a useful cover word beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your reed plan kept the cover instruction understood. Next the crew needed your explanation, with words, pictures, or dictation all available.

Tell the Crew

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 8, Episode 4

Sun route: meadow

Lark summarized the meadow plan and put the shade behind the packed kit instead of where it would cover the mat. She held the source beside her summary so the difference could be checked. Nib waited to learn which practical job would help.

“Tell us the part we need,” Lark invited warmly. “I can remember a job,” Nib declared proudly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **help**

“An explanation needs a useful order,” Lark explained gently. “Read first, then, and last. Use the source to tell us the destination and kit, and show where the shade belongs. Your actual words or arranged pictures can become our draft.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try first, then, last. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Tell us the meadow plan so we can take useful jobs,” Lark invited warmly. “What needs correcting in my summary?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **First pack the mat. Then pack the shade.**

“Which packing job comes first in this example?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark kept the atlas draft open for your explanation instead of substituting a canned sentence. Nib could take the shade-packing job while Lark checked the route source. The crew's jobs would follow the explained plan. Its next related page would add a condition the first invitation had not discussed.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write one part of your own summary beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The meadow summary kept what you actually explained. A separate condition space stayed empty until the next relevant source was read.

Pine route: lookout

Lark's pine summary put the sketch board into the route bag but forgot the place to pause and use it. She set the source beside that incomplete summary. Nib held the board ready, waiting for a job that belonged to the actual sketching plan.

“Tell us the part we need,” Lark invited warmly. “I can remember a job,” Nib declared proudly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **help**

“Tell information in an order someone can use,” Lark explained gently. “First, then, and last can organize the explanation. Use the source to name the destination, kit, and planned pause. You can speak, arrange pictures, or dictate.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try first, then, last. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Explain the pine plan and check my summary,” Lark invited warmly. “Where should the board be used?”

Lark supplied board aloud before the passage. You could use those topic words with her help; their unprepared spellings were not words you had to decode alone.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **First pack the board. Then pack the coat.**

“Which item is packed after the board in this example?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The draft stayed open for your real explanation. Nib could pack and carry the board while Lark checked the direction source. Their tasks would come from the plan rather than silent corrections. The pine outing remained yours, with a later source still needed for its condition space.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write one word from your own summary beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your pine summary kept the order you explained. The next page would discuss a condition that affected the stopping place without replacing the chosen sketching purpose.

Reed route: book stop

Lark's reed summary put the mat into its cover and left the book uncovered. She brought the source closer so you could check the two jobs. Nib waited beside the actual dry book cover, ready to take a useful packing task.

“Tell us the part we need,” Lark invited warmly. “I can remember a job,” Nib declared proudly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **help**

“Explain the plan so another person can act on it,” Lark invited warmly. “Read first, then, and last. Use the source to show what stays dry and how. You can speak, arrange the pictures, or dictate your own explanation.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try first, then, last. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Check my summary and explain the book's protection,” Lark asked gently. “Which thing belongs in the dry cover?”

Lark supplied cover aloud before the passage. You could use those topic words with her help; their unprepared spellings were not words you had to decode alone.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **First cover the book. Then pack the mat.**

“What happens to the book before the mat is packed?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The atlas draft remained open for your actual explanation. Nib could take the cover-and-book job while Lark checked the path information. The crew would follow the same understood plan. A condition affecting the waterside stop still needed its own source.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write a word from your actual explanation beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your reed summary kept the plan you explained. The final condition space stayed available for information about the bank and its dry alternative.

A New Topic on Our Route

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 8, Episode 5

Sun route: meadow

The next meadow page compared the sunny clearing with its shaded edge. The first invitation had shown cheerful sunshine, but a comfortable stop needed more than a bright picture. Nib held the mat in the middle of the sun while Lark read the additional condition.

“Our first page sounded so sunny,” Nib remarked. “Our next page helps us prepare,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **first**

“A related source can qualify an earlier plan,” Lark explained thoughtfully. “Compare its information with your purpose. We don't have to abandon the meadow to use its shaded edge; we can keep the outing and improve where we stop.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sun, rain, wind, wet. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the meadow condition,” Lark invited gently. “Which stop fits the purpose while allowing shade?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The sun is on the mat. The shade is by the path.**

“Where does the passage put the shade?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The atlas draft could name the shaded edge instead of an exposed patch in the clearing. Nib kept the shade cloth with the mat. Lark left the reason beside the revision so another reader could understand it. The condition space now had information rather than a guess based on the invitation's mood.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write shade beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your meadow plan could now be read as a whole: destination, equipment, and a reason for the shaded stop. A longer page would connect the approach with that final place.

Pine route: lookout

A related pine page compared an exposed viewpoint with a sheltered platform. Nib admired the open view, then caught the edge of his sketch paper as it lifted in the breeze. Lark set the wind information beside the original sketching purpose.

“Our first page sounded so sunny,” Nib remarked. “Our next page helps us prepare,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **first**

“Compare the second topic with the first purpose,” Lark explained gently. “A wind condition can change the stopping place without changing our interest in sketching. Keep the relevant words in the reason for the revised plan.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sun, rain, wind, wet. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the pine condition,” Lark invited gently. “Which platform gives the sketch board a sheltered place?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The wind is by the pine. The shelter has a wide platform.**

“Which place has the wide platform?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The draft could choose the sheltered viewing platform while keeping the pine lookout and sketching purpose. Nib packed the light coat and board together. Lark recorded why an exposed spot might be less useful for loose paper. The condition became part of the plan instead of an unwelcome surprise at the end.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write wind beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your pine plan now included a condition and a suitable alternative within the same outing. The longer combined page would need both its approach paragraph and its stopping-place paragraph.

Reed route: book stop

The reed condition page showed a wet bank beside a dry boardwalk platform. The pleasant waterside invitation had not discussed where to set a paper book after rain. Nib kept the protected volume off the ground while Lark compared the two stopping places.

“Our first page sounded so sunny,” Nib remarked. “Our next page helps us prepare,” Lark replied thoughtfully.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **first**

“Use the new topic to qualify the first plan,” Lark explained gently. “A wet bank doesn't mean abandoning our book stop. Read for the dry alternative and keep the reason attached to it, so another reader can make the same useful choice.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try sun, rain, wind, wet. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the bank condition,” Lark invited gently. “Which supported place keeps the reading stop dry?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The bank is wet. The platform is dry.**

“Which place is dry?” Lark asked gently. “What does the other sentence tell us to account for?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The draft could name the dry boardwalk platform. The cover and mat stayed in the kit, ready for the same chosen book purpose. Lark recorded the wet-bank reason beside the alternative. The creek did not need a new boat crossing for this plan; the dry supported route was already shown.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write wet beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your reed plan now held the relevant condition. The longer page would connect the dry approach and the actual supported reading stop.

The Longer Useful Page

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 8, Episode 6

Sun route: meadow

The meadow page had two short paragraphs. Nib read the approach and began to fold the plan shut. Lark put a wing beside the second paragraph. Arriving at the clearing was not the same as choosing the shaded edge where the outing would work comfortably.

“I had a plan after the first bit,” Nib admitted. “The next bit belongs to the plan too,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sun**

“Read a longer page in manageable parts,” Lark invited warmly. “Pause after a paragraph, keep its meaning, then read the next. You can ask for a shorter span or help. We need both approach and stop, not a long performance for its own sake.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try shelter, platform, stop, path. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Use both paragraphs to choose our actual meadow stop,” Lark invited gently. “What does the second add?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

Follow the wide path. Stop in the shade.
Set the mat in the shade. Keep the path dry.

“Where do we stop after following the path?” Lark asked gently. “Which paragraph adds what to do there?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The draft would connect the broad dry approach with the shaded-edge stop. Nib checked that the mat and shade cloth matched that place. All four planning spaces could now be filled from actual sources. One fresh note remained to check a current condition before the outing.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write stop beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your meadow draft was complete enough to use. Its current condition would be checked once more before anyone led the real walk.

Pine route: lookout

The pine page's first paragraph described the path to the lookout. Nib started choosing a view before the second paragraph was read. Lark left the page open. Its next section described the sheltered platform where a board could rest level.

“I had a plan after the first bit,” Nib admitted. “The next bit belongs to the plan too,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sun**

“Keep meaning across short sections,” Lark explained warmly. “Read a paragraph, pause, then connect the next one. A shorter span or help is available. Our job is to use the whole relevant page, not read for as long as possible.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try shelter, platform, stop, path. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read both paragraphs,” Lark invited gently. “Which stop does the complete pine page identify?”

Lark supplied board aloud before the passage. You could use those topic words with her help; their unprepared spellings were not words you had to decode alone.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

Follow the wide pine path. Pass the hut.
Stop on the sheltered platform. Set the board on the rest.

“Where should the board rest?” Lark asked gently. “Which paragraph supplies that final stopping information?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The draft would join the approach to the sheltered level platform. The coat and sketch board fitted that actual stop. Nib kept the plan open long enough to check the final line. The four information spaces were filled; a fresh note would still provide one current check.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write platform beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your pine plan now included the useful stopping place as well as the approach. A new note could confirm or revise one current detail before the sketching outing.

Reed route: book stop

The reed page began with the boardwalk approach. Nib started toward the nearest bank picture before Lark showed the second paragraph. The complete page led to the fixed dry reading platform, where the book could stay supported beside the water.

“I had a plan after the first bit,” Nib admitted. “The next bit belongs to the plan too,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **sun**

“Read the relevant sections together,” Lark invited warmly. “We can pause between paragraphs or shorten a span. Keep what the first part says, then let the next part add to it. Reading longer only helps when the information stays useful.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try shelter, platform, stop, path. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Use both paragraphs to find the actual reed stop,” Lark invited gently. “What does the second say about the book?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

Follow the dry path. Pass the reed bank.
Stop on the dry platform. Set the book on the fixed rest.

“Where should the book be set?” Lark asked gently. “Which paragraph gives the supported stop?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The draft would connect the dry boardwalk to its fixed platform and book rest. The protective cover and mat matched that place. All four information spaces were filled. The last fresh note would check a current condition without replacing the chosen book outing.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write path beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your reed plan now held the approach and exact reading place. One fresh note remained before the crew followed it on the real outing.

A New Note for Our Path

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 8, Episode 7

Sun route: meadow

The new meadow note stayed face down until your first attempt. Nib waited beside the actual mat and shade cloth. Lark kept the prepared plan nearby without reading the new answer aloud. The outing would remain available whether the note needed help or not.

“A new note, not a new test of bravery,” Lark explained warmly. “We can use what it tells us,” Nib agreed.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **shelter**

“Use familiar spellings on this fresh note,” Lark invited warmly. “Try it before a model. Then decide whether its information changes the mat's place or our preparation. We can look at the real scene after the reading.”

“Read today's meadow note,” Lark invited gently. “Does its information call for moving the mat into shade?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The mat is in the sun. The shade is by the path.**

“Where is the mat now?” Lark asked gently. “How does that compare with the planned stop?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

After the attempt, the crew could compare the note with the mat's real position and the shaded-edge plan. Any needed help would stay attached to the same text. Nib would carry the preparation agreed from that reading, without an accuracy threshold deciding whether the outing could happen.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write mat beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your meadow plan was ready for actual use, with its final decision tied to the fresh note. The next chapter would follow the child's directions rather than announce an outing that had not happened.

Pine route: lookout

The new pine note lay unopened beside the route plan. Nib waited with the sketch board while Lark left the answer unspoken. The coat remained packed. A fresh note could help a supported reader lead a real trip; it was not a last test to earn permission.

“A new note, not a new test of bravery,” Lark explained warmly. “We can use what it tells us,” Nib agreed.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **shelter**

“Try the new note using familiar spellings,” Lark invited warmly. “Then compare its information with our prepared approach. Ask for help if a part needs it. We'll check the real scene only after giving the text its own reading.”

“Read today's pine note,” Lark invited gently. “Does it support our approach or change it?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The pine is by the hut. The path is wide.**

“What does the note say about the path?” Lark asked gently. “Does that fit the approach we prepared?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

After the attempt, the crew could compare the note with the actual pine, hut, and wide path. Lark would record any help honestly. The plan could be confirmed or revised from its information. Nib kept the board ready for the selected supported platform.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write pine beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your pine plan was ready for use. The outing would follow the actual decision made from the note, with support still available while the child led.

Reed route: book stop

The new reed note remained covered while Nib held the protected book. Lark set the prepared dry-platform plan beside it without reading the new answer aloud. The boat mentioned in a note could be observed from the bank; it did not turn this chosen boardwalk outing into an unplanned crossing.

“A new note, not a new test of bravery,” Lark explained warmly. “We can use what it tells us,” Nib agreed.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **shelter**

“Read the fresh note before a model,” Lark invited warmly. “Then decide what it changes, if anything, about the dry stopping place. Help is available. We will compare the actual scene after the text has had its first reading.”

“Read today's reed note,” Lark invited gently. “Which information matters to where we set the book?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The bank is wet. The boat is at the dock.**

“Which sentence matters most to keeping a book off wet ground?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

After the attempt, the crew could check the wet bank and the dock from dry ground. The selected book stop remained on its supported platform unless the actual reading gave a reason to revise it. Needed support would be recorded as support, with no invented independent result.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write bank beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your reed plan was ready for the real outing. Nib would take the assigned book-cover job while Lark followed the child's directions along the supported dry approach.

The Atlas We Make

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 8, Episode 8

Sun route: meadow

The meadow plan lay ready with its actual destination, kit, shaded stop, and condition. Lark moved beside you, prepared to follow the first direction. Nib carried the mat and shade cloth in the practical role agreed earlier. The atlas still had room for corrections from what the outing really showed.

“Which way, explorer?” Lark asked with a smile. “Ready with the useful things,” Nib replied proudly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **pine**

“Lead us using the plan you made,” Lark invited warmly. “We can help read or check a detail. At the stop, compare the page with the real place. A useful atlas records what we actually find, including anything that needs changing.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try map, mat, page. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Give our first direction, then check the shaded-edge stop against the page,” Lark invited gently.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The mat is in the shade. The path is dry.**

“What does this example tell the next visitor about the mat and path?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

At the shaded edge, Nib spread the mat on dry ground and fixed the shade cloth to its supports. The crew had time for the picnic or flower viewing you had chosen at the start. Lark checked the real approach against the page. Back at camp, she laid the draft beside your observations for approval and corrections. Nib set the approved source, paper, and ink on the portable press. A new atlas page emerged from the real materials.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write a word from your approved page beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark placed the checked meadow entry in the atlas. Its destination, kit, shaded stop, and condition belonged to the outing just completed. Your explorer badge settled into the collection case. The Atlas We Make joined the seven earlier books. The meadow visit had its own finished ending; other invitations remained free choices for another day.

Pine route: lookout

The pine plan lay ready with its equipment, sheltered platform, and current condition. Lark stood beside you to follow the first direction. Nib took the assigned sketch-board job. The page would be checked against the actual view rather than presented as a perfect atlas before the crew had used it.

“Which way, explorer?” Lark asked with a smile. “Ready with the useful things,” Nib replied proudly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **pine**

“Use your plan to lead the outing,” Lark invited warmly. “We can support a word or check a detail with you. At the platform, compare the real approach, stopping place, and equipment with the page. Corrections make a route more useful to its next reader.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try map, mat, page. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Give the first pine direction and check our platform against the plan,” Lark invited gently.

Lark supplied board aloud before the passage. You could use those topic words with her help; their unprepared spellings were not words you had to decode alone.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The board is on the rest. The platform is dry.**

“What does the example tell a sketching visitor about the stop?” Lark asked gently.

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

At the sheltered level platform, Nib set the sketch board on its support. The light coat stayed ready as planned. There was time to make the chosen lookout sketch and compare the real approach with the page. Back at camp, Lark laid the draft beside your observations for approval and corrections. Nib prepared the approved source, paper, and ink. The press made a page from that real account, without claiming the untaken routes had been visited.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write a word from your approved entry beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The checked pine entry and actual sketch took their places in the atlas. Your explorer badge marked the shared project. Lark bound The Atlas We Make and placed it beside the seven earlier books. The lookout outing was finished, its page ready for another reader. You could choose another book or route whenever you wished.

Reed route: book stop

The reed plan was ready beside the protected book. Lark waited to follow the first direction. Nib took the agreed cover-and-book job while the mat stayed packed for the dry platform. The real outing would check the page before it was approved for another reader.

“Which way, explorer?” Lark asked with a smile. “Ready with the useful things,” Nib replied proudly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **pine**

“Lead us with the information you gathered,” Lark invited warmly. “Ask for help wherever it is useful. At the reading stop, compare the actual dry approach and fixed rest with the plan. The final atlas should keep your checked account rather than an invented perfect trip.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try map, mat, page. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Give our first reed direction, then check the dry platform against the page,” Lark invited gently.

Lark supplied cover aloud before the passage. You could use those topic words with her help; their unprepared spellings were not words you had to decode alone.

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The book is on the dry rest. The cover is by the mat.**

“Where does this example keep the book?” Lark asked gently. “What remains ready beside the mat?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

At the dry platform, Nib set the book on the fixed ledge and spread the mat. The crew shared the quiet reading chosen at the start. The cover stayed ready to protect the book again. Back at camp, Lark laid the draft beside the real observations for approval and corrections. Nib set the approved source, paper, and ink on the press. The atlas page came from that checked account, with no other route claimed as visited.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write a word from your approved entry beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The checked reed entry joined the atlas, giving another reader the dry approach, useful kit, supported stop, and wet-bank alternative. Your explorer badge settled beside the earlier keepsakes. The Atlas We Make joined the library as the eighth finished book. The waterside outing was complete, and the crew was free to choose another story without a new locked mystery.